

COLEGIO BILINGÜE CIUDAD BLANCA

English Department

ENGLISH LANGUAGE CURRICULUM

Learning Outcomes & Objectives

Preschool through 11th Grade

ESL Expectations | SWBAT & I Can Formats

Aligned to 19 Curriculum Standards Across 5 Strands

Academic Year 2025–2026

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	2
Part 1: Curriculum Standards	5
Part 2: Standards Alignment Table.....	6
Part 3: Learning Objectives by Grade	7
Prekinder	7
🔊 LISTENING.....	7
🗣️ SPEAKING.....	7
📖 READING	7
✍️ WRITING	8
Kinder.....	9
🔊 LISTENING.....	9
🗣️ SPEAKING.....	9
📖 READING	9
✍️ WRITING	10
Prepa.....	11
🔊 LISTENING.....	11
🗣️ SPEAKING.....	11
📖 READING	11
✍️ WRITING	12
1st Grade	13
🔊 LISTENING.....	13
🗣️ SPEAKING.....	13
📖 READING	14
✍️ WRITING	14
2nd Grade	16
🔊 LISTENING.....	16
🗣️ SPEAKING.....	16
📖 READING	17
✍️ WRITING	17
3rd Grade	19
🔊 LISTENING.....	19
🗣️ SPEAKING.....	19
📖 READING	20
✍️ WRITING	20
4th Grade	22
🔊 LISTENING.....	22
🗣️ SPEAKING.....	22

 READING	23
 WRITING	24
5th Grade	26
 LISTENING.....	26
 SPEAKING.....	26
 READING	27
 WRITING	28
6th Grade	30
 LISTENING.....	30
 SPEAKING.....	30
 READING	31
 WRITING	32
7th Grade	34
 LISTENING.....	34
 SPEAKING.....	35
 READING	36
 WRITING	37
8th Grade	40
 LISTENING.....	40
 SPEAKING.....	41
 READING	42
 WRITING	43
9th Grade	46
 LISTENING.....	46
 SPEAKING.....	47
 READING	48
 WRITING	49
10th Grade	52
 LISTENING.....	52
 SPEAKING.....	53
 READING	54
 WRITING	55
11th Grade	58
 LISTENING.....	58
 SPEAKING.....	59
 READING	60
 WRITING	62
Part 4: Vertical Alignment by Skill.....	64

 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT: LISTENING.....	64
 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT: SPEAKING.....	67
 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT: READING	70
 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT: WRITING	73
Graduation Profile.....	76

Part 1: Curriculum Standards

Five Strands | 19 Standards | Colegio Bilingüe Ciudad Blanca

Strand 1: Critical Analysis and Interpretation (Standards 1–5)

1. Comprehend and Infer
2. Analyze Craft & Structure
3. Evaluate and Critique
4. Synthesize & Connect
5. Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts

Strand 2: Effective Writing & Production (Standards 6–10)

6. Write for a Range of Purposes
7. Develop & Strengthen Writing
8. Conduct Research
9. Use Evidence
10. Apply Technical Conventions

Strand 3: Oral Communication & Collaboration (Standards 11–13)

11. Engage in Collaborative Dialogue
12. Present Ideas Effectively
13. Evaluate Spoken Content

Strand 4: Language, Vocabulary & Personal Command (Standards 14–15)

14. Acquire & Use Vocabulary
15. Understand Language Systems

Strand 5: Personal, Cultural & Critical Engagement (Standards 16–19)

16. Make Personal and Metacognitive Connections
17. Explore Identity & Culture
18. Develop as Critical & Competent Learners
19. Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies

Part 2: Standards Alignment Table

Standards coverage across all grade levels — PK through 11th Grade

✓ = Standard addressed at this grade level Shaded cells indicate active alignment

Standard	PK	K	PP	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1. Comprehend and Infer	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
2. Analyze Craft & Structure			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
3. Evaluate and Critique					✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
4. Synthesize & Connect	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
5. Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
6. Write for a Range of Purposes	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
7. Develop & Strengthen Writing	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
8. Conduct Research	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
9. Use Evidence					✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
10. Apply Technical Conventions	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
11. Engage in Collaborative Dialogue	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
12. Present Ideas Effectively			✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
13. Evaluate Spoken Content					✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
14. Acquire & Use Vocabulary	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓				
15. Understand Language Systems	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓			
16. Make Personal and Metacognitive Connections	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
17. Explore Identity & Culture	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
18. Develop as Critical & Competent Learners	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
19. Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies										✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Part 3: Learning Objectives by Grade

SWBAT & I Can Statements | Organized by Grade, Cycle, and Skill

Prekinder

Preschool Cycle | 8 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-PK.1

SWBAT Students will be able to show understanding of a single spoken word or simple command (e.g., 'sit,' 'clap,' 'look') by responding with a physical action.

I Can I can hear a word my teacher says and show I understand it by doing something, like clapping or sitting down.

Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary)

L-PK.2

SWBAT Students will be able to recognize their own name and the names of 2–3 classmates when spoken aloud in a group setting.

I Can I can hear my name and my friends' names and know who is being called.

Standards: 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

SPEAKING

S-PK.1

SWBAT Students will be able to repeat single words and simple phrases modeled by the teacher, such as color names, numbers 1–5, and greetings (e.g., 'hello,' 'goodbye').

I Can I can say words and short phrases after my teacher, like 'hello,' 'one,' and 'red.'

Standards: 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)

S-PK.2

SWBAT Students will be able to use a single English word or gesture to express a basic need or feeling in the classroom (e.g., 'water,' 'help,' pointing while saying 'this').

I Can I can say a word or use my hands to tell my teacher what I need or how I feel.

Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

READING

R-PK.1

SWBAT Students will be able to recognize that printed text carries meaning by pointing to words and pictures in a big book or classroom display when prompted.

I Can I can look at a book and know that the words and pictures tell me something.

Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 15 (Understand Language Systems)

R-PK.2**SWBAT**

Students will be able to identify and name at least 8 letters of the English alphabet (uppercase), particularly those in their own first name.

I Can

I can point to and say some letters of the alphabet, especially the ones in my name.

Standards: 15 (Understand Language Systems), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

 WRITING
W-PK.1**SWBAT**

Students will be able to demonstrate pre-writing readiness by drawing controlled shapes (lines, circles, crosses) and holding a writing tool with a functional grip.

I Can

I can hold a pencil and draw lines and circles to get ready for writing letters.

Standards: 10 (Apply Technical Conventions), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

W-PK.2**SWBAT**

Students will be able to attempt to write or trace the letters of their own first name, producing at least the first letter with recognizable form.

I Can

I can try to write my name, and I can make the first letter of my name.

Standards: 10 (Apply Technical Conventions), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Single commands & own name	Kinder: 2-step commands & topic recognition
Speaking	Repeating words & basic needs	Kinder: Naming objects & simple exchanges
Reading	Print awareness & 8 letters	Kinder: Full alphabet & simple word recognition
Writing	Pre-writing shapes & tracing name	Kinder: Copying full name & labeling pictures

Kinder

Preschool Cycle | 8 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-K.1 *(Builds on L-PK.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to follow two-step oral instructions given by the teacher using familiar classroom language and visual support (e.g., 'Pick up your pencil and draw a circle').
I Can	I can listen carefully and do two things in a row when my teacher tells me, like picking up my pencil and drawing something.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

L-K.2 *(Builds on L-PK.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify the main subject of a short spoken text (e.g., a simple song, chant, or read-aloud) by pointing to a corresponding picture or object.
I Can	I can listen to a short song or story and point to a picture that shows what it is about.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary)</i>	

SPEAKING

S-K.1 *(Builds on S-PK.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to name at least 15 familiar classroom and household objects, animals, and colors using single words or short noun phrases in English with minimal prompting.
I Can	I can say the names of things I see at school and at home in English without much help from my teacher.
<i>Standards: 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

S-K.2 *(Builds on S-PK.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to participate in a simple two-turn exchange with a classmate or teacher using a modeled sentence frame (e.g., 'What is this?' / 'It is a ____').
I Can	I can ask and answer a short question with my friend or teacher using words my teacher has shown me.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

READING

R-K.1 *(Builds on R-PK.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to recognize and name all 26 uppercase and most lowercase letters of the English alphabet, and identify the beginning sound of 5–8 familiar words.
I Can	I can point to and say all the big letters and most small letters of the alphabet, and I can tell what sound a word starts with.
<i>Standards: 15 (Understand Language Systems), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

R-K.2 *(Builds on R-PK.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to use picture clues and repeated text patterns in a simple illustrated book to predict or 'read along' with a familiar story.
I Can	I can look at the pictures and patterns in a book to help me figure out what the words might say.

Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)

 WRITING
W-K.1 *(Builds on W-PK.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write their full first name independently using recognizable uppercase and lowercase letters with appropriate size and spacing.
I Can	I can write my whole first name by myself, using big and small letters the right way.

Standards: 10 (Apply Technical Conventions), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

W-K.2 *(Builds on W-PK.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to copy a modeled word of 3–4 letters and use it to label a drawing, demonstrating left-to-right directionality and letter formation.
I Can	I can copy a short word and write it next to my drawing to show what it is, writing from left to right.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	2-step commands & topic identification	Prepa: Identifying key details & simple story sequence
Speaking	Naming objects & 2-turn exchanges	Prepa: Describing with adjectives & sharing personal ideas
Reading	Full alphabet, initial sounds & picture clues	Prepa: CVC words, sight words & story comprehension
Writing	Writing own name & copying labeled words	Prepa: Writing simple sentences with subject + verb

Prepa

Preschool Cycle | 8 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-PP.1 (Builds on L-K.1)

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify at least two key details (e.g., who, what, where) from a short read-aloud or spoken text supported by visuals.
I Can	I can listen to a short story or talk and tell two important things I heard, like who it was about and what happened.
Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary)	

L-PP.2 (Builds on L-K.2)

SWBAT	Students will be able to recognize the sequence of two or three events in a short listened story by ordering picture cards or retelling with sentence starters (e.g., 'First... Then...').
I Can	I can listen to a story and put the events in order using words like 'first' and 'then.'
Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)	

SPEAKING

S-PP.1 (Builds on S-K.1)

SWBAT	Students will be able to describe a familiar person, animal, or object using at least one adjective and one noun in a short phrase or sentence (e.g., 'a big, brown dog' / 'She is tall').
I Can	I can describe things and people I know by saying what they look like using describing words in English.
Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary)	

S-PP.2 (Builds on S-K.2)

SWBAT	Students will be able to share a personal preference or simple idea in English using a sentence frame (e.g., 'I like ____ because ____.') during a guided class discussion or pair activity.
I Can	I can tell my teacher and friends what I like and give a simple reason for it in English.
Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)	

READING

R-PP.1 (Builds on R-K.1)

SWBAT	Students will be able to decode simple CVC words (e.g., cat, sit, hop) and recognize a set of up to 15 high-frequency sight words in a short illustrated text.
I Can	I can read short three-letter words and words I see a lot, like 'the,' 'and,' and 'is,' in a simple book.
Standards: 15 (Understand Language Systems), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)	

R-PP.2 *(Builds on R-K.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify the main character and at least one key event in a simple illustrated story, responding orally or by drawing with a written label.
I Can	I can read or listen to a simple story and tell who the main character is and one thing that happened.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)</i>	

 WRITING**W-PP.1** *(Builds on W-K.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write a simple two- to three-word sentence using a subject and verb, with support from a word bank or sentence frame (e.g., 'I see a ____.' / 'The dog runs.').
I Can	I can write a short sentence in English using a naming word and an action word, with help from my word bank.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)</i>	

W-PP.2 *(Builds on W-K.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to produce a simple personal sentence about themselves (e.g., 'I am ____.' / 'I like ____.') accompanied by an original drawing, using legible letter formation and left-to-right directionality.
I Can	I can write one sentence about myself in English and draw a picture to go with it, making sure my letters are clear and I write from left to right.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Key details & sequence	1st Grade: Main idea, predictions & multi-step tasks
Speaking	Describing & sharing preferences	1st Grade: Full sentences, conversations & oral presentations
Reading	CVC words, sight words & story comprehension	1st Grade: Fluent word reading, story elements & personal connections
Writing	Simple sentences & personal writing	1st Grade: Multi-sentence writing with structure & purpose

1st Grade

1st Cycle | 12 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-1.1 (Builds on L-PP.1)

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify the main idea and at least two supporting details from a short read-aloud or listened text, using visual support and guided questioning.
I Can	I can listen to a short story or talk and tell what it is mainly about and two important details that support it.
Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary)	

L-1.2 (Builds on L-PP.2)

SWBAT	Students will be able to retell the beginning, middle, and end of a short listened story using sequencing words (e.g., 'First,' 'Then,' 'Finally') and at least one detail from each part.
I Can	I can listen to a story and retell it in order — the beginning, middle, and end — using words like 'first,' 'then,' and 'finally.'
Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)	

L-1.3 (New at this level)

SWBAT	Students will be able to infer the meaning of an unfamiliar word heard in a short spoken text by using context clues such as surrounding words, tone, and accompanying visuals.
I Can	I can hear a word I don't know and use the other words around it and the pictures to make a good guess about what it means.
Standards: 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)	

SPEAKING

S-1.1 (Builds on S-PP.1)

SWBAT	Students will be able to describe a familiar person, place, or object using a complete sentence that includes a subject, verb, and at least one adjective (e.g., 'The small cat is sleeping on the chair.').
I Can	I can describe something or someone I know using a full sentence with a describing word, like 'The small cat is sleeping.'
Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary)	

S-1.2 (Builds on S-PP.2)

SWBAT	Students will be able to participate in a short structured conversation of 3–4 turns with a partner, using learned sentence frames to ask questions, respond, and add a comment.
I Can	I can have a short back-and-forth conversation with a classmate in English, asking questions and sharing my ideas for a few turns.
Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)	

S-1.3 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT Students will be able to present 3–4 sentences about a personally meaningful topic to a small group, speaking audibly and maintaining eye contact with support from a drawing or visual aid.

I Can I can stand up and tell my group a few sentences about something important to me, looking at them while I speak and using a picture to help me.

Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

READING**R-1.1** *(Builds on R-PP.1)*

SWBAT Students will be able to decode CVC and simple CCVC words and recognize a set of up to 30 high-frequency sight words, reading aloud simple sentences with developing fluency and expression.

I Can I can read short words and words I see a lot, and I can read simple sentences out loud smoothly, trying to make them sound natural.

Standards: 15 (Understand Language Systems), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

R-1.2 *(Builds on R-PP.2)*

SWBAT Students will be able to identify the main character, setting, problem, and solution in a simple illustrated story, responding through guided discussion, drawing, or written labels.

I Can I can read a simple story and tell who the main character is, where the story happens, what the problem is, and how it gets solved.

Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)

R-1.3 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT Students will be able to make a simple text-to-self connection after reading or listening to a story, explaining how a character's experience relates to their own life using a sentence frame prompt.

I Can I can read a story and make a connection to my own life, explaining how something in the story is like something that happened to me.

Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)

WRITING**W-1.1** *(Builds on W-PP.1)*

SWBAT Students will be able to write 2–3 connected sentences on a familiar topic using a sentence frame scaffold, demonstrating basic subject-verb agreement and ending punctuation.

I Can I can write two or three sentences about something I know, making sure each sentence has a naming part and a doing part, and ends with a period or question mark.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)

W-1.2 *(Builds on W-PP.2)*

SWBAT Students will be able to write a short personal narrative of 3–4 sentences about a real experience, including who was involved, what happened, and how they felt, supported by an illustration.

I Can I can write a short true story about something that happened to me, telling who was there, what happened, and how I felt, and I can draw a picture to go with it.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

W-1.3 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT Students will be able to apply basic writing conventions including capitalization of the first word in a sentence and proper nouns, use of end punctuation, and spacing between words.

I Can I can remember to use a capital letter at the start of my sentences and for names, put a period or question mark at the end, and leave spaces between my words.

Standards: 10 (Apply Technical Conventions), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Main idea, sequencing & vocabulary in context	2nd Grade: Inferring meaning, listening for purpose & evaluating spoken content
Speaking	Complete sentences, structured conversation & simple presentation	2nd Grade: Extended conversation, opinion sharing & formal presentations
Reading	Word fluency, story elements & text-to-self connection	2nd Grade: Reading strategies, text-to-world connections & simple inference
Writing	2-3 sentence writing, personal narrative & conventions	2nd Grade: Paragraph structure, descriptive writing & editing for clarity

2nd Grade

1st Cycle | 12 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-2.1 *(Builds on L-1.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to make a simple inference about a character's feelings or a speaker's purpose by listening to a short spoken text and identifying clues in tone, word choice, and context.
I Can	I can listen to a story or talk and make a smart guess about how a character feels or why someone is speaking, using clues I hear.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 3 (Evaluate & Critique)</i>	

L-2.2 *(Builds on L-1.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to a short informational text or classroom explanation and distinguish between key information and supporting details, recording findings through drawing or simple notes.
I Can	I can listen to someone explain something and tell the difference between the most important information and the extra details that support it.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)</i>	

L-2.3 *(Builds on L-1.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to a classmate's short oral presentation and identify one thing that was communicated clearly and one question they still have, using a structured response frame.
I Can	I can listen to my classmate speak and tell them one thing they explained well and ask them one question about something I want to know more about.
<i>Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

SPEAKING

S-2.1 *(Builds on S-1.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to state a simple opinion about a familiar topic and support it with at least one reason, using sentence frames (e.g., 'I think ____ because ____').
I Can	I can tell my classmates what I think about something and give at least one reason why I think that way.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

S-2.2 *(Builds on S-1.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to engage in an extended conversation of 5–6 turns with a partner, using language to agree, disagree politely, and ask for clarification.
I Can	I can have a longer conversation with a classmate where I agree or respectfully disagree and ask them to explain more if I don't understand.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

S-2.3 *(Builds on S-1.3)*

SWBAT Students will be able to deliver a short prepared oral presentation of 5–6 sentences to the whole class on a familiar topic, with a clear opening statement, supporting details, and a closing sentence.

I Can I can present to my whole class using a clear beginning, some details in the middle, and a closing sentence, while using a picture to help my audience understand.

Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

READING**R-2.1** *(Builds on R-1.1)*

SWBAT Students will be able to read a short leveled text aloud with developing fluency, attending to punctuation cues for phrasing and expression, and self-correcting errors that affect meaning.

I Can I can read a short book out loud, paying attention to punctuation to help me read smoothly and expressively, and I can fix my mistakes when something doesn't make sense.

Standards: 15 (Understand Language Systems), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

R-2.2 *(Builds on R-1.2)*

SWBAT Students will be able to make a simple inference about why a character behaves a certain way, supporting their answer with at least one piece of textual evidence.

I Can I can read a story and make a smart guess about why a character does something, and I can show where in the text I found my clue.

Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 9 (Use Evidence)

R-2.3 *(Builds on R-1.3)*

SWBAT Students will be able to make a text-to-world connection by identifying how the events or ideas in a story relate to something they know about the real world.

I Can I can read a story and connect it to something I know about the world around me, and I can explain that connection in a sentence or two.

Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)

WRITING**W-2.1** *(Builds on W-1.1)*

SWBAT Students will be able to write a structured paragraph of 4–5 sentences that includes a topic sentence, two or three supporting details, and a closing sentence, on a familiar topic with teacher guidance.

I Can I can write a paragraph that starts with a sentence telling my main idea, has details in the middle to support it, and ends with a closing sentence.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)

W-2.2 (*Builds on W-1.2*)

SWBAT Students will be able to write a descriptive narrative of 4–5 sentences about a personal experience or imagined event, incorporating at least two descriptive adjectives and a clear sequence of events.

I Can I can write a story about something real or imagined, using describing words to make it interesting and telling what happened in order.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

W-2.3 (*Builds on W-1.3*)

SWBAT Students will be able to review and edit their own writing for correct capitalization, end punctuation, and spelling of familiar words, using a simple peer or self-editing checklist.

I Can I can read back my own writing and fix mistakes in capitalization, punctuation, and spelling using a checklist, and I can help a classmate do the same.

Standards: 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Inference, key vs. supporting info & evaluating peers	3rd Grade: Listening critically, identifying bias & synthesizing across texts
Speaking	Opinion with reason, extended dialogue & class presentation	3rd Grade: Structured debate, persuasive speaking & formal presentation
Reading	Fluency, character inference with evidence & text-to-world	3rd Grade: Reading strategies across genres, theme & compare/contrast
Writing	Paragraph structure, descriptive narrative & self-editing	3rd Grade: Multi-paragraph writing, opinion writing & research-based writing

3rd Grade

1st Cycle | 12 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-3.1 (Builds on L-2.1)

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify the speaker's point of view in a short listened text and explain whether the information presented seems balanced or one-sided, using a guided discussion frame.
I Can	I can listen to someone speak and decide whether they are sharing all sides of an idea or only one side, and I can explain my thinking to my classmates.
Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)	

L-3.2 (Builds on L-2.2)

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to two short spoken texts on the same topic and identify one idea they share and one way they differ, recording their thinking using a simple graphic organizer.
I Can	I can listen to two short talks or stories about the same topic and find one thing they both say and one thing that is different between them.
Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 1 (Comprehend & Infer)	

L-3.3 (Builds on L-2.3)

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to a peer's oral presentation and provide structured constructive feedback using a feedback frame that addresses content clarity, organization, and one suggestion for improvement.
I Can	I can listen carefully to my classmate's presentation and give them helpful feedback about what was clear, how well it was organized, and one thing they could do better.
Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)	

SPEAKING

S-3.1 (Builds on S-2.1)

SWBAT	Students will be able to state a clear opinion on a familiar topic and support it with two or three reasons, using transitional language (e.g., 'First,' 'Also,' 'Finally') in a structured small group discussion or mini-debate.
I Can	I can share my opinion on a topic and give two or three reasons to support it, using words like 'first,' 'also,' and 'finally' to organize my ideas.
Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)	

S-3.2 (Builds on S-2.2)

SWBAT	Students will be able to respond to a classmate's opinion by acknowledging their point of view, agreeing or respectfully disagreeing, and offering a supporting reason or example.
I Can	I can listen to what my classmate thinks and respond to their idea politely, sharing whether I agree or disagree and explaining why with a reason or example.

Standards: 11 (*Engage in Collaborative Dialogue*), 4 (*Synthesize & Connect*)**S-3.3** (*Builds on S-2.3*)

SWBAT Students will be able to deliver a rehearsed oral report of 6–8 sentences on a self-selected or assigned topic, organizing ideas into an introduction, body, and conclusion, and responding to at least one question from the audience.

I Can I can present a short report to my class with a clear beginning, middle, and end, and I can answer a question my classmates ask me about my topic.

Standards: 12 (*Present Ideas Effectively*), 8 (*Conduct Research*)**READING****R-3.1** (*Builds on R-2.1*)

SWBAT Students will be able to apply at least two reading comprehension strategies (e.g., visualizing, questioning, re-reading) when encountering an unfamiliar text, and explain which strategy helped them most and why.

I Can I can use reading strategies like making pictures in my mind or asking myself questions to help me understand a new text, and I can explain which strategy worked best for me.

Standards: 18 (*Develop as Critical & Competent Learners*), 16 (*Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections*)**R-3.2** (*Builds on R-2.2*)

SWBAT Students will be able to identify the central theme or lesson of a story and compare how two characters from the same or different texts respond to a similar challenge, using textual evidence.

I Can I can read a story and explain the big lesson or message, and I can compare how two characters deal with a similar problem using examples from the text.

Standards: 1 (*Comprehend & Infer*), 4 (*Synthesize & Connect*)**R-3.3** (*Builds on R-2.3*)

SWBAT Students will be able to read two short texts from different cultural contexts and identify how the perspectives, values, or experiences of the characters or authors differ.

I Can I can read two stories or texts from different places or cultures and explain how the people in them see the world differently, and I can share what I learned from comparing them.

Standards: 5 (*Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts*), 17 (*Explore Identity & Culture*)**WRITING****W-3.1** (*Builds on W-2.1*)

SWBAT Students will be able to write a structured multi-paragraph text (3 paragraphs) that includes an introductory paragraph with a clear main idea, one body paragraph with supporting details, and a concluding paragraph that restates the main idea.

I Can I can write three paragraphs — one to introduce my idea, one to give details and support it, and one to wrap it up — making sure my writing has a clear beginning, middle, and end.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)

W-3.2 (Builds on W-2.2)

SWBAT	Students will be able to write a structured opinion piece of 3–4 paragraphs that clearly states a position, provides two supporting reasons with examples, and ends with a concluding statement.
I Can	I can write an opinion piece where I clearly say what I think, give two reasons with examples to support my view, and finish with a sentence that wraps up my argument.
Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 9 (Use Evidence)	

W-3.3 (Builds on W-2.3)

SWBAT	Students will be able to conduct a simple guided research task using two provided sources, take brief notes in their own words, and incorporate at least two pieces of researched information into a short written report, citing the source by title.
I Can	I can use two sources to find information about a topic, write notes in my own words, and include what I learned in a short report, telling my reader where I found the information.
Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 9 (Use Evidence)	

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Point of view, synthesis & constructive feedback	4th Grade: Critical listening, note-taking & formal evaluation
Speaking	Multi-reason argument, responding to peers & oral report	4th Grade: Formal debate, persuasive speaking & multimedia presentation
Reading	Reading strategies, theme, compare & cultural perspectives	4th Grade: Genre study, author's purpose, literary devices & research
Writing	Multi-paragraph, opinion writing & guided research	4th Grade: Essay writing, persuasive writing & independent research

4th Grade

2nd Cycle | 16 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-4.1 *(Builds on L-3.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to a short informational talk or recorded speech and evaluate whether the speaker's claims are supported by clear evidence, identifying at least one strong point and one weak or unsupported claim.
I Can	I can listen to someone make an argument and decide whether their reasons and evidence are strong or weak, and I can explain my thinking to my class.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)</i>	

L-4.2 *(Builds on L-3.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to two or three short spoken texts on a related topic and organize the key ideas from each source into a simple note-taking graphic organizer, identifying connections and differences.
I Can	I can listen to two or three talks on the same topic and organize what each one says into notes, showing where they agree and where they are different.
<i>Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 8 (Conduct Research)</i>	

L-4.3 *(Builds on L-3.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to evaluate a peer's or recorded speaker's oral presentation using a structured rubric that addresses content accuracy, clarity of organization, use of evidence, and delivery.
I Can	I can use a rubric to evaluate a presentation and write specific feedback about whether the ideas were clear, well-organized, supported with evidence, and delivered effectively.
<i>Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 3 (Evaluate & Critique)</i>	

L-4.4 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to apply active listening strategies (e.g., mental summarizing, asking clarifying questions, connecting to prior knowledge) during a classroom discussion or lesson and demonstrate comprehension through a brief written or oral reflection.
I Can	I can use active listening strategies like summarizing in my head, connecting to what I already know, and asking questions to help me understand and remember what I hear in class.
<i>Standards: 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

SPEAKING

S-4.1 *(Builds on S-3.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to present a persuasive argument on a familiar topic that includes a clear position, three supporting reasons with examples, and an acknowledgment of one opposing view.
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I Can	I can make a persuasive argument by stating my position clearly, giving three reasons with examples, and showing that I understand what someone who disagrees might say.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)</i>	

S-4.2 *(Builds on S-3.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to take an active role in a small group discussion by contributing ideas, inviting quieter members to share, building on classmates' contributions, and helping the group stay on topic.
I Can	I can be an active and responsible participant in a group discussion by sharing my ideas, asking my quieter classmates what they think, and helping keep the conversation focused.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

S-4.3 *(Builds on S-3.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to deliver a prepared presentation of 8–10 sentences supported by a visual aid, speaking clearly, varying tone for emphasis, and responding to at least two audience questions with elaboration.
I Can	I can present my ideas to the class using a visual aid, speaking clearly and changing my tone to emphasize important points, and I can answer questions from my audience with more detail.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

S-4.4 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to distinguish between informal and formal spoken language and demonstrate the ability to adjust their register appropriately in two contrasting speaking contexts.
I Can	I can tell the difference between casual and formal ways of speaking, and I can switch between them depending on who I am talking to and what the situation is.
<i>Standards: 15 (Understand Language Systems), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

READING**R-4.1** *(Builds on R-3.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to independently select and apply appropriate reading comprehension strategies when reading both fiction and non-fiction texts, and reflect on their effectiveness in a reading journal entry.
I Can	I can choose the right reading strategies for different kinds of texts and explain in my reading journal which strategies helped me understand the text and why.
<i>Standards: 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

R-4.2 *(Builds on R-3.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify the author's purpose in a given text and explain how specific literary devices (e.g., simile, repetition, dialogue) contribute to that purpose, using textual evidence.
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I Can	I can read a text and explain why the author wrote it and how the techniques they used help achieve that purpose, using examples from the text.
<i>Standards: 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

R-4.3 <i>(Builds on R-3.3)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to analyze how the cultural background or context of a text influences its characters, themes, or messages, and connect these insights to their own cultural identity.
I Can	I can read a text and explain how the culture it comes from shapes its characters and ideas, and I can connect what I learn to my own culture and experiences.
<i>Standards: 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

R-4.4 <i>(New at this level)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to read an extended leveled text independently over a sustained period and demonstrate comprehension through a structured response that addresses plot, character development, and personal reaction.
I Can	I can read a longer book on my own and show that I understood it by writing about or discussing the plot, the characters, and what I personally thought about it.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

WRITING

W-4.1 <i>(Builds on W-3.1)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to write a structured 5-paragraph essay that includes an introduction with a clear thesis statement, three body paragraphs each with a topic sentence and supporting details, and a conclusion.
I Can	I can write a five-paragraph essay with a strong introduction that states my main idea, three paragraphs that support it with details, and a conclusion that wraps everything up.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)</i>	

W-4.2 <i>(Builds on W-3.2)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to write a persuasive essay of 4–5 paragraphs that presents a clear argument, supports it with at least three reasons and relevant examples, addresses a counterargument, and uses persuasive language conventions.
I Can	I can write a persuasive essay where I argue my point clearly, support it with reasons and examples, acknowledge what someone who disagrees might say, and use language that helps convince my reader.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

W-4.3 <i>(Builds on W-3.3)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to conduct an independent research task using three or more sources, take organized notes using their own words, synthesize information into a structured research report of 4–5 paragraphs, and include a simple bibliography.

I Can	I can research a topic using at least three sources, take notes in my own words, write a research report that combines what I found, and list my sources at the end.
<i>Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

W-4.4 <i>(New at this level)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to apply the full writing process — planning, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing — incorporating specific feedback from a peer review session to improve content, organization, and language use.
I Can	I can take my writing through the full writing process — planning, drafting, revising with feedback from a classmate, editing for mistakes, and publishing a final version I am proud of.
<i>Standards: 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Critical evaluation, multi-source synthesis & active listening	5th Grade: Implicit meaning, media evaluation & academic discussion
Speaking	Persuasive argument, group facilitation & register switching	5th Grade: Formal debate, data presentation & academic language
Reading	Strategy independence, author's purpose & cultural analysis	5th Grade: Literary analysis, inference across genres & source evaluation
Writing	5-paragraph essay, persuasive writing & writing process	5th Grade: Analytical essays, comparative writing & advanced research

5th Grade

2nd Cycle | 16 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-5.1 *(Builds on L-4.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify implicit messages and rhetorical techniques (e.g., repetition, emotional appeal, loaded language) in a listened speech or advertisement, explaining how these techniques influence the audience.
I Can	I can listen to a speech or advertisement and identify hidden messages and persuasive techniques like emotional language or repetition, and explain how they are used to influence people.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)</i>	

L-5.2 *(Builds on L-4.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to multiple perspectives on a controversial topic presented in a discussion or recorded debate and synthesize the key arguments from each side into a balanced summary.
I Can	I can listen to different people argue different sides of a topic and summarize the key points from each side fairly, noting where they agree and where they clash.
<i>Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

L-5.3 *(Builds on L-4.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to critically evaluate a short video, podcast, or multimedia presentation for credibility, bias, and effectiveness, using a structured evaluation framework.
I Can	I can watch or listen to a video or podcast and evaluate whether the information is trustworthy, whether it shows any bias, and how effectively it communicates its message.
<i>Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 3 (Evaluate & Critique)</i>	

L-5.4 *(Builds on L-4.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to an academic lecture or content-area explanation of 3–5 minutes and produce organized notes using a structured format (e.g., Cornell notes or a concept map) that captures main ideas, key details, and questions.
I Can	I can listen to a longer academic talk and take organized notes that capture the main ideas, important details, and questions I still have, using a note-taking format.
<i>Standards: 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners), 8 (Conduct Research)</i>	

SPEAKING

S-5.1 *(Builds on S-4.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to participate in a formal structured debate, presenting an assigned position with at least three evidence-based arguments, rebutting an opponent's claim using counter-evidence, and maintaining a respectful and academic tone.
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I Can	I can take part in a formal debate, argue my side with evidence, respond to my opponent's arguments with counter-evidence, and keep a respectful, academic tone even when I disagree.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)</i>	

S-5.2 *(Builds on S-4.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to lead or co-lead a Socratic seminar-style discussion on a text or topic, posing open-ended questions, inviting and building on peers' contributions, and helping the group reach a deeper understanding.
I Can	I can lead a class discussion by asking open-ended questions, building on what my classmates say, and helping the group think more deeply about a topic or text together.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)</i>	

S-5.3 *(Builds on S-4.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to deliver a research-based presentation of 10–12 sentences that incorporates data, quotes, or statistics from at least two sources, uses visual aids effectively, and demonstrates clear signposting language.
I Can	I can present research to my class using data and quotes from my sources, visual aids that support my points, and language that guides my audience through my presentation clearly.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

S-5.4 *(Builds on S-4.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to demonstrate consistent use of academic vocabulary and formal register in classroom discussions, presentations, and debates, while also explaining the appropriateness of informal register in social contexts.
I Can	I can use academic vocabulary and formal language confidently in school settings like discussions and presentations, and I can explain when and why it is appropriate to use more casual language instead.
<i>Standards: 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary), 15 (Understand Language Systems)</i>	

READING**R-5.1** *(Builds on R-4.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to critically read an informational or persuasive text, distinguishing between fact and opinion, identifying the author's assumptions, and evaluating the reliability of the evidence presented.
I Can	I can read an informational or persuasive text and tell the difference between facts and opinions, identify what the author assumes to be true, and decide how reliable their evidence is.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

R-5.2 *(Builds on R-4.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write or present a structured literary analysis of a short story or novel excerpt, examining how the author develops character, conveys theme, and uses structural choices to create meaning.
I Can	I can analyze a story and explain how the author builds characters, develops the theme, and uses structural techniques like flashback or foreshadowing to create meaning for the reader.
<i>Standards: 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure), 1 (Comprehend & Infer)</i>	

R-5.3 <i>(Builds on R-4.3)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to compare two texts from different cultural or historical contexts, analyzing how each reflects the values, beliefs, or challenges of its time and place.
I Can	I can read two texts from different cultures or time periods and compare what each one says about the values and challenges of its world, and explain what a modern reader can learn from them.
<i>Standards: 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)</i>	

R-5.4 <i>(Builds on R-4.4)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to read an independently chosen novel or extended text and produce an analytical reading response that examines a theme, a character arc, or a significant structural choice, supported by at least three pieces of textual evidence.
I Can	I can read a novel on my own and write an analytical response that explores a theme, character development, or structural choice, using at least three examples from the text.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)</i>	

WRITING

W-5.1 <i>(Builds on W-4.1)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to write an analytical essay of 5–6 paragraphs in which they develop a clear arguable thesis, support it with textual evidence and analysis across multiple body paragraphs, and conclude with a synthesis of their argument's significance.
I Can	I can write an analytical essay with a clear arguable thesis, body paragraphs that use evidence and explain its significance, and a conclusion that synthesizes my overall argument.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

W-5.2 <i>(Builds on W-4.2)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to write a comparative essay of 5–6 paragraphs that examines two texts, ideas, or perspectives, using a clear organizational structure, appropriate comparative language, and textual evidence from both sources.
I Can	I can write a comparative essay that examines two texts or ideas side by side, using a clear structure, comparison language, and evidence from both sources to support my analysis.
<i>Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)</i>	

W-5.3 (*Builds on W-4.3*)**SWBAT**

Students will be able to plan and write an extended research report of 5–7 paragraphs, evaluating the credibility of at least four sources, integrating information from multiple sources without plagiarizing, and formatting a bibliography.

I Can

I can write a detailed research report that uses information from at least four credible sources, combines ideas in my own words, and includes a properly formatted bibliography.

Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)

W-5.4 (*Builds on W-4.4*)**SWBAT**

Students will be able to identify and articulate features of their own writing voice and deliberately apply stylistic choices to enhance the clarity, engagement, and effectiveness of a piece of writing through multiple drafts.

I Can

I can describe my own writing style and deliberately use techniques like varied sentence length, precise word choice, and appropriate tone to make my writing clearer and more effective across multiple drafts.

Standards: 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Implicit meaning, media critique & lecture note-taking	6th Grade: Complex argument, media comparison & academic synthesis
Speaking	Formal debate, Socratic seminar & academic language	6th Grade: Position defense, inquiry facilitation & capstone presentation
Reading	Critical reading, literary analysis & cross-cultural comparison	6th Grade: Close reading, literary critique & self-directed reading project
Writing	Analytical essay, comparative essay & personal voice	6th Grade: Extended essay, genre flexibility & independent research project

6th Grade

2nd Cycle | 16 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-6.1 *(Builds on L-5.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to evaluate the strength and logic of a complex argument heard in an academic discussion, recorded lecture, or documentary, identifying logical fallacies, unsupported claims, and emotional manipulation.
I Can	I can listen to a complex argument and identify logical fallacies, weak claims, and emotional manipulation, and I can present a clear critique of the argument's strengths and weaknesses.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)</i>	

L-6.2 *(Builds on L-5.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to an extended academic discussion or panel debate, synthesize the key positions and supporting arguments, and independently formulate a reasoned response that draws on at least two of the perspectives heard.
I Can	I can follow an extended academic discussion or debate, synthesize the main positions and arguments, and independently form and express my own reasoned response drawing from what I heard.
<i>Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

L-6.3 *(Builds on L-5.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to compare how two different media sources frame the same topic or event, analyzing differences in language, emphasis, and perspective, and presenting their comparison in a structured format.
I Can	I can compare how two different media sources present the same topic and analyze how their choice of words, what they emphasize, and their perspective shape how the audience understands the issue.
<i>Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)</i>	

L-6.4 *(Builds on L-5.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to a series of academic inputs on a research topic, synthesize notes from all sources into a coherent research outline, and use this outline as the basis for an independent writing or presentation task.
I Can	I can listen to several different academic sources on the same research topic, organize my notes into a research outline, and use that outline to write a report or create a presentation independently.
<i>Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

SPEAKING

S-6.1 *(Builds on S-5.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to independently research and present a position on a complex topic in a formal academic context, defending their argument against challenging questions from peers or teachers with elaborated, evidence-based responses.
I Can	I can independently research a complex topic, present my position formally, and defend my argument against tough questions from my classmates or teacher using evidence and well-developed reasoning.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

S-6.2 *(Builds on S-5.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to facilitate a structured collaborative inquiry discussion on a complex text or issue, designing at least three open-ended discussion questions in advance, managing participation equitably, and synthesizing the group's conclusions.
I Can	I can plan and lead a collaborative discussion by preparing thoughtful open-ended questions, making sure everyone has a voice, and summarizing what the group concluded at the end.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)</i>	

S-6.3 *(Builds on S-5.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to deliver a polished capstone-style oral presentation of 12–15 minutes on an independently researched topic, demonstrating command of content, effective use of visual and data supports, confident delivery, and professional question management.
I Can	I can deliver a full, polished presentation on a topic I have researched independently, using visuals and data effectively, speaking with confidence, and handling questions from my audience professionally.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 8 (Conduct Research)</i>	

S-6.4 *(Builds on S-5.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to demonstrate flexible and confident command of formal academic English across a range of speaking contexts encountered in secondary school, adapting vocabulary, tone, and structure appropriately to each context.
I Can	I can speak confidently and appropriately in different school situations — from formal presentations and oral exams to group work and conversations — adjusting my language and tone to fit each context.
<i>Standards: 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary), 15 (Understand Language Systems)</i>	

READING**R-6.1** *(Builds on R-5.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to conduct a close reading of a complex informational or argumentative text, annotating for main claims, evidence quality, logical structure, and author bias, and producing a written critical evaluation.
I Can	I can read a complex text closely and carefully, annotating it for claims, evidence, logic, and bias, and write a critical evaluation that judges how effectively the author makes their argument.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)</i>	

R-6.2 *(Builds on R-5.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write an independent literary critique of a complete short story or novel excerpt, analyzing how the author's use of narrative techniques (e.g., unreliable narrator, symbolism, irony) creates layers of meaning.
I Can	I can write an independent literary critique analyzing how an author uses techniques like symbolism, irony, or an unreliable narrator to create deeper meaning, using close evidence from the text.

Standards: 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure), 1 (Comprehend & Infer)

R-6.3 *(Builds on R-5.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to read and respond to a curated selection of texts from diverse global, cultural, and linguistic contexts across the year, synthesizing recurring themes, values, and tensions in a cumulative reflective portfolio entry.
I Can	I can read texts from many different cultures and perspectives and write a reflective response that identifies recurring themes, values, and tensions across all the texts I have read.

Standards: 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

R-6.4 *(Builds on R-5.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to design and complete a self-directed independent reading project — selecting a text, setting reading goals, tracking progress, producing an analytical written or multimodal response, and sharing with an authentic audience.
I Can	I can choose my own book, set goals for my reading, track my progress, write or create an analytical response, and share my experience and insights with a real audience.

Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

 WRITING
W-6.1 *(Builds on W-5.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write an extended analytical essay of 6–8 paragraphs that develops a nuanced, arguable thesis, sustains a coherent line of reasoning, integrates and analyzes textual evidence, and demonstrates awareness of counterarguments.
I Can	I can write a long analytical essay with a nuanced thesis, develop my argument consistently across all paragraphs, use and analyze evidence, and address counterarguments to strengthen my position.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 9 (Use Evidence)

W-6.2 *(Builds on W-5.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write effectively across at least three genres, demonstrating understanding of the conventions, purpose, and audience of each genre, and reflecting on how their writing choices differ across genres.
I Can	I can write in at least three different genres and explain how my choices about structure, language, tone, and purpose change depending on what kind of writing I am doing and who I am writing for.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)

W-6.3 (Builds on W-5.3)

SWBAT	Students will be able to independently plan, research, draft, revise, and publish an extended research project of 7–9 paragraphs, demonstrating full academic integrity through proper paraphrasing, quotation, and citation.
I Can	I can independently complete a full research project — choosing my topic, researching carefully, writing and revising with proper citations, and presenting my findings to a real audience.
Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)	

W-6.4 (Builds on W-5.4)

SWBAT	Students will be able to compile a curated writing portfolio that includes at least four pieces from across the year representing different genres and purposes, with a reflective introduction analyzing their growth as a writer and goals for secondary school.
I Can	I can put together a writing portfolio with examples of my best work, write a reflection that analyzes how I have grown as a writer, what I do well, what I need to work on, and what my goals are for secondary school.
Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)	

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Complex argument evaluation, media comparison & synthesis	7th Grade: Rhetorical analysis, scholarly discourse & subtext
Speaking	Position defense, inquiry facilitation & capstone presentation	7th Grade: Nuanced argument, seminar, disciplinary language & oral exam
Reading	Close reading, literary critique & global text synthesis	7th Grade: Ideological analysis, intertextuality & exam strategies
Writing	Extended essay, genre flexibility & research project	7th Grade: Literary essay, scholarly research & timed writing

7th Grade

3rd Cycle | 24 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-7.1 *(Builds on L-6.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to analyze the rhetorical strategies (e.g., ethos, pathos, logos) used in a speech, podcast, or academic lecture, explaining how each strategy contributes to the speaker's overall persuasive effect.
I Can	I can listen to a speech or lecture and identify the rhetorical strategies the speaker uses and explain how each one strengthens or weakens their argument.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)</i>	

L-7.2 *(Builds on L-6.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to an academic discussion or recorded scholarly talk and evaluate the quality of reasoning and evidence presented, distinguishing between strong, well-supported arguments and weak or misleading ones.
I Can	I can listen to an academic talk or discussion and use an analytical framework to evaluate which arguments are well-reasoned and well-supported and which ones are weak or misleading.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 1 (Comprehend & Infer)</i>	

L-7.3 *(Builds on L-6.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to analyze how language, visuals, and editorial choices in two or more media texts construct a particular version of reality on a social or political topic.
I Can	I can analyze how the language, images, and editorial choices in different media texts shape how audiences understand a social or political issue, and I can present my analysis clearly and critically.
<i>Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)</i>	

L-7.4 *(Builds on L-6.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to extended academic content across subject areas and produce discipline-appropriate notes that capture central arguments, key terminology, and open questions for further inquiry.
I Can	I can listen to academic content from different subject areas and take notes that capture the main arguments, key vocabulary, and questions I want to explore further.
<i>Standards: 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners), 8 (Conduct Research)</i>	

L-7.5 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify subtext and implied meaning in a performed or recorded dramatic or literary text, explaining what is communicated beyond the literal words through tone, pause, and delivery.
I Can	I can listen to a dramatic or literary performance and identify what is being communicated beneath the surface through the speaker's tone, pauses, and delivery choices.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)</i>	

L-7.6 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT Students will be able to apply specific listening comprehension strategies in a timed, exam-style context — including previewing questions before listening, identifying key words, and managing uncertainty.

I Can I can use exam listening strategies like reading questions before I listen, focusing on key words, and making smart choices when I am unsure, to improve my performance on listening tests.

Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

**SPEAKING****S-7.1** *(Builds on S-6.1)*

SWBAT Students will be able to construct and orally defend a nuanced academic argument on a complex topic, anticipating and addressing multiple counterarguments with evidence-based rebuttals.

I Can I can build and defend a complex academic argument, anticipate what others might argue against me, respond with evidence, and show that I understand the topic is not simply black and white.

Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)

S-7.2 *(Builds on S-6.2)*

SWBAT Students will be able to lead an academic discussion that models intellectual humility — acknowledging uncertainty, revising their thinking in response to new evidence or peer contributions, and helping the group navigate disagreement productively.

I Can I can lead a discussion where I show intellectual humility by admitting when I am unsure, changing my thinking when I hear a good argument, and helping my group work through disagreement respectfully.

Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

S-7.3 *(Builds on S-6.3)*

SWBAT Students will be able to prepare and deliver an independently designed academic seminar contribution of 10–15 minutes on a self-selected topic, demonstrating mastery of content, effective visual and rhetorical support, and management of audience questions.

I Can I can independently design and deliver a full academic seminar contribution, demonstrating deep knowledge of my topic, using rhetorical and visual strategies effectively, and confidently managing challenging questions.

Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 9 (Use Evidence)

S-7.4 *(Builds on S-6.4)*

SWBAT Students will be able to deploy discipline-specific vocabulary and discourse conventions appropriate to at least two subject areas in both spoken presentations and academic discussions.

I Can I can use the specific vocabulary and ways of speaking that belong to different school subjects when I present or discuss ideas in those subjects.

Standards: 14 (Acquire & Use Vocabulary), 15 (Understand Language Systems)

S-7.5 (New at this level)

SWBAT	Students will be able to deliver a structured personal reflection of 5–7 minutes exploring their own cultural identity, linguistic background, or personal experience, connecting their narrative to broader social or global themes.
I Can	I can deliver a personal reflection that explores my identity, culture, or personal experiences and connects my story to bigger social or global ideas, then invite my classmates to respond.

Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

S-7.6 (New at this level)

SWBAT	Students will be able to prepare for and perform in a structured oral examination or speaking assessment, demonstrating organized thinking, fluent delivery, appropriate academic register, and composure under assessment conditions.
I Can	I can prepare for and perform well in a speaking assessment or oral exam by organizing my ideas clearly, speaking fluently and appropriately, and staying calm and focused under exam conditions.

Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)

READING

R-7.1 (Builds on R-6.1)

SWBAT	Students will be able to conduct a sustained close reading of a complex literary or non-literary text, annotating for diction, syntax, tone, and structure, and producing a written analysis that explains how these elements work together to create meaning.
I Can	I can closely read a complex text and annotate it for word choice, sentence structure, tone, and organization, then write an analysis explaining how these elements combine to create meaning.

Standards: 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure), 1 (Comprehend & Infer)

R-7.2 (Builds on R-6.2)

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify and analyze the philosophical, ideological, or cultural perspective embedded in a literary text, explaining how the author's worldview shapes the narrative, characters, and themes.
I Can	I can read a literary text and identify the author's deeper philosophical or cultural worldview, and explain how that perspective shapes the story, characters, and themes using evidence.

Standards: 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)

R-7.3 (Builds on R-6.3)

SWBAT	Students will be able to read texts across at least three genres on a shared thematic topic and synthesize insights across genres, analyzing how genre shapes the treatment of the theme.
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I Can	I can read texts from different genres on the same theme and analyze how the genre shapes how the theme is explored and what it means for the reader.
<i>Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)</i>	

R-7.4 *(Builds on R-6.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to independently select and read an extended text through the lens of a critical framework (e.g., gender, power, cultural identity, social justice), producing a written or multimodal response applying the chosen lens.
I Can	I can choose a book to read independently and analyze it through a critical lens — like gender, power, or social justice — and produce a response that applies that lens to explore deeper meanings.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

R-7.5 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to identify and analyze intertextual connections between two or more texts — including allusions, thematic parallels, and structural echoes — and explain what these connections reveal about each text's meaning and cultural significance.
I Can	I can identify connections between texts like shared themes, allusions, or structural parallels, and explain what these connections reveal about the meaning and cultural significance of each text.
<i>Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)</i>	

R-7.6 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to apply exam-specific reading strategies (e.g., skimming for gist, scanning for detail, managing time across questions, eliminating unlikely answers) in timed practice assessments.
I Can	I can use reading exam strategies like skimming, scanning, time management, and process of elimination to improve my accuracy and efficiency on timed reading tests.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

 WRITING**W-7.1** *(Builds on W-6.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write a sophisticated literary essay of 7–9 paragraphs that develops and sustains a complex, arguable thesis, integrates close textual evidence with analytical commentary, and maintains a consistent academic voice.
I Can	I can write a long literary essay with a complex thesis that I develop consistently throughout, using close evidence with my own analytical commentary and maintaining a clear academic voice.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

W-7.2 *(Builds on W-6.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to independently select an appropriate genre for a given communicative purpose and audience, producing a polished piece that demonstrates mastery of the genre's conventions, tone, and structural requirements.
I Can	I can choose the right genre for my purpose and audience, write a polished piece that follows the conventions of that genre, and explain why I made the choices I did.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

W-7.3 *(Builds on W-6.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to independently produce a scholarly research essay of 8–10 paragraphs that develops an original research question, synthesizes evidence from at least five credible sources, and maintains full academic integrity.
I Can	I can write a scholarly research essay with an original research question, synthesize evidence from at least five credible sources, use proper citation and paraphrasing, and present findings in a clear, well-argued structure.
<i>Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)</i>	

W-7.4 *(Builds on W-6.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write a developed reflective essay on their identity and growth as a writer, analyzing specific pieces from their writing history, identifying signature strengths and challenges, and articulating a vision for future writing development.
I Can	I can write a reflective essay about my growth as a writer, using specific pieces as evidence, honestly identifying my strengths and challenges, and setting a clear vision for how I want to develop further.
<i>Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

W-7.5 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write an extended piece of creative writing that demonstrates deliberate use of literary techniques — including narrative voice, imagery, structural choices, and thematic development — to create a meaningful and engaging text.
I Can	I can write an extended creative piece and deliberately use literary techniques like narrative voice, imagery, and structure to develop a theme and create a meaningful experience for my reader.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)</i>	

W-7.6 *(New at this level)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to produce a well-organized, coherent written response under timed exam conditions, applying strategies for planning, drafting, and reviewing within a time limit.
I Can	I can write a well-organized response under timed conditions by using strategies to plan quickly, write efficiently, and review my work before time runs out.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)</i>	

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Rhetorical analysis, scholarly discourse, subtext & exam strategies	8th Grade: Cross-cultural rhetoric, ideology, digital media & advanced exam
Speaking	Nuanced argument, intellectual humility, seminar & oral exam	8th Grade: Scholarly discourse, panel presentation & spoken word
Reading	Close reading, ideological analysis, intertextuality & exam	8th Grade: Multiple critical lenses, power & ideology, positionality
Writing	Literary essay, genre mastery, scholarly research & timed writing	8th Grade: Critical theory essay, public audience & extended research

8th Grade

3rd Cycle | 24 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-8.1 *(Builds on L-7.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to compare the use of rhetorical strategies across two speeches or talks from different cultural or institutional contexts, analyzing how context shapes the choice and effectiveness of rhetorical techniques.
I Can	I can compare how rhetorical strategies are used differently in two different contexts — like a political speech and an academic lecture — and explain how the context shapes which techniques are used.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)</i>	

L-8.2 *(Builds on L-7.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to a scholarly or intellectual argument and identify the underlying ideological assumptions that shape the speaker's position, explaining how these assumptions influence what evidence is selected.
I Can	I can listen to a scholarly argument and dig beneath the surface to identify the ideological assumptions driving it, explaining how those assumptions shape what evidence the speaker chooses.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)</i>	

L-8.3 *(Builds on L-7.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to evaluate the media literacy implications of a digital content piece, analyzing how algorithm-driven distribution, audience targeting, and platform design influence how the content is received.
I Can	I can evaluate a piece of digital content and analyze how it is designed, distributed, and targeted to shape how different audiences receive and interpret it.
<i>Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

L-8.4 *(Builds on L-7.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to two or more academic sources that present conflicting information and produce a synthesized analytical summary that explains the disagreement and evaluates the relative strength of each position.
I Can	I can listen to academic sources that disagree with each other, write a synthesis explaining the disagreement clearly, evaluate which position is better supported, and identify what further evidence would help resolve the debate.
<i>Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 8 (Conduct Research)</i>	

L-8.5 *(Builds on L-7.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to analyze how voice, perspective, and power dynamics are constructed in a spoken narrative or dramatic performance, examining whose story is centered, whose is marginalized, and how these choices affect the listener's sympathies.
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I Can	I can listen to a spoken narrative or dramatic performance and analyze whose voice is centered, whose is left out, and how these choices shape how the listener feels and thinks.
<i>Standards: 1 (Comprehend & Infer), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

L-8.6 *(Builds on L-7.6)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to demonstrate proficiency across a range of complex exam-style listening tasks — including multiple choice, gap fill, matching, and short answer — applying targeted strategies for each question type.
I Can	I can handle different types of listening exam questions — like multiple choice, gap fill, and short answer — using the right strategy for each one and performing consistently well under timed conditions.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

 SPEAKING**S-8.1** *(Builds on S-7.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to engage in high-level intellectual discourse on a complex academic topic, sustaining a position across an extended discussion, incorporating scholarly vocabulary, and demonstrating the ability to revise their thinking when presented with compelling counter-evidence.
I Can	I can engage in a high-level academic discussion, sustain and defend my position over an extended conversation, use scholarly vocabulary, and show I can genuinely change my mind when the evidence warrants it.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 3 (Evaluate & Critique)</i>	

S-8.2 *(Builds on S-7.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to facilitate a complex academic discussion that incorporates diverse cultural and ideological perspectives, managing potential conflict respectfully, ensuring equitable participation, and synthesizing viewpoints into a nuanced conclusion.
I Can	I can facilitate a complex discussion that brings in diverse cultural and ideological perspectives, manage disagreements respectfully, make sure all voices are heard, and guide the group toward a nuanced conclusion.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

S-8.3 *(Builds on S-7.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to co-design and deliver a collaborative academic panel or symposium-style presentation with peers, contributing a distinct and well-researched individual segment and collectively managing audience questions.
I Can	I can work with my classmates to design and deliver a panel-style presentation, contribute my own well-researched segment, coordinate smoothly with my co-presenters, and manage questions from the audience as a team.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

S-8.4 *(Builds on S-7.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to consciously code-switch between formal academic English and their own personal or cultural voice across different speaking contexts, reflecting on how each mode serves different communicative purposes and identities.
I Can	I can consciously move between formal academic English and my own personal or cultural way of speaking depending on the context, and reflect on how each mode expresses a different part of who I am.
<i>Standards: 15 (Understand Language Systems), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

S-8.5 *(Builds on S-7.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write and perform an original spoken word piece, personal essay reading, or narrative monologue that explores a personal, cultural, or social theme, using literary and rhetorical techniques deliberately.
I Can	I can write and perform an original spoken word piece or personal narrative that explores a theme that matters to me, using literary and rhetorical techniques deliberately to engage my audience.
<i>Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes)</i>	

S-8.6 *(Builds on S-7.6)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to perform at a high level in a formal oral examination or speaking assessment, demonstrating fluency, coherence, lexical range, and grammatical accuracy, and producing a self-evaluative reflection afterward.
I Can	I can perform well in a formal oral exam, demonstrating fluent, coherent, and accurate speaking, and I can reflect honestly afterward on what I did well and what I need to keep working on.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

READING**R-8.1** *(Builds on R-7.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to apply two or more critical reading lenses (e.g., feminist, postcolonial, Marxist, psychological) to a single complex text, analyzing how each lens reveals different dimensions of meaning.
I Can	I can apply two or more critical lenses to the same text and analyze how each one reveals different layers of meaning, then explain which lens I find most illuminating and why.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)</i>	

R-8.2 *(Builds on R-7.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to analyze how power relationships and ideological positions are encoded in the language of a literary text — including word choice, narrative focalization, and the construction of 'otherness' — and connect these to social and historical context.
I Can	I can analyze how a literary text encodes power and ideology through its language choices and narrative perspective, and I can connect these features to their historical and social context.
<i>Standards: 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)</i>	

R-8.3 *(Builds on R-7.3)*

SWBAT Students will be able to design and complete an extended intertextual reading project that traces a theme, motif, or social issue across at least four texts from different genres, time periods, and cultural contexts.

I Can I can design and complete a reading project that traces a theme or issue across at least four texts from different genres, time periods, and cultures, and write a synthesis drawing meaningful connections across all of them.

Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)

R-8.4 *(Builds on R-7.4)*

SWBAT Students will be able to reflect on how their own social position, cultural background, and prior experiences influence their reading, writing a positionality statement that acknowledges their perspective and considers how a different reader might interpret the same text.

I Can I can reflect honestly on how my own background and experiences shape how I read a text, and I can consider how someone from a different background might read the same text completely differently.

Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

R-8.5 *(Builds on R-7.5)*

SWBAT Students will be able to situate a literary text within its broader literary and cultural tradition, identifying the conventions it follows, challenges, or subverts, and analyzing what the author's engagement with that tradition reveals.

I Can I can place a literary text within its broader tradition and analyze whether the author follows, challenges, or subverts the conventions of that tradition, and explain what this reveals about their artistic intentions.

Standards: 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)

R-8.6 *(Builds on R-7.6)*

SWBAT Students will be able to demonstrate consistent mastery across a full range of secondary-level exam reading tasks — including literary analysis, informational comprehension, vocabulary in context, and extended response — managing time effectively across a full exam paper.

I Can I can handle all the different types of reading questions on a secondary exam using the right strategy for each and managing my time well across the whole paper.

Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

 WRITING
W-8.1 *(Builds on W-7.1)*

SWBAT Students will be able to write a fully developed critical essay of 8–10 paragraphs that applies a named critical framework to a literary text, developing a sophisticated original thesis, and situating the argument within a broader critical conversation.

I Can	I can write a long critical essay that applies a theoretical lens to a literary text, develops a sophisticated original thesis, and positions my argument within the broader critical conversation.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

W-8.2 <i>(Builds on W-7.2)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to produce a polished piece of writing intended for an authentic public audience (e.g., an op-ed, a letter to a public official, a magazine feature), demonstrating full mastery of the genre's conventions and a confident authorial voice.
I Can	I can write a polished piece for a real public audience demonstrating full command of the genre, a clear sense of who I am writing for and why, and a confident, distinctive voice.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)</i>	

W-8.3 <i>(Builds on W-7.3)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to independently produce an extended research paper of 10–12 paragraphs that develops an original, arguable thesis, synthesizes evidence from at least six credible sources including academic publications, and maintains full academic integrity.
I Can	I can write an extended research paper with an original thesis, synthesize evidence from at least six credible sources, integrate them skillfully, and maintain full academic integrity throughout.
<i>Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)</i>	

W-8.4 <i>(Builds on W-7.4)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to curate a metacognitive writing development portfolio that includes representative pieces across genres, a detailed analytical introduction tracing development as a writer, and a forward-looking statement of writing goals for the diversified cycle.
I Can	I can curate a writing portfolio with pieces that show my range as a writer, write a detailed analytical introduction tracing my growth, and set clear, ambitious goals for my writing development in the final two years.
<i>Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

W-8.5 <i>(Builds on W-7.5)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to write an extended creative piece that engages meaningfully with a social, political, or cultural theme, demonstrating sophisticated use of literary craft — including narrative structure, characterization, symbolism, and tone.
I Can	I can write an extended creative piece that explores a social, political, or cultural theme with depth and nuance, using sophisticated literary craft to create a meaningful and resonant work.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

W-8.6 <i>(Builds on W-7.6)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to produce high-quality written responses across a range of exam task types (e.g., analytical essay, creative writing, directed writing, summary) under timed conditions, demonstrating consistent command of structure and task-specific conventions.

I Can	I can write high-quality responses to different kinds of exam writing tasks under timed conditions, demonstrating strong command of structure, language, and the specific conventions of each task type.
Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)	

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Cross-cultural rhetoric, ideology, digital media & advanced exam	9th Grade: Epistemic media, capstone synthesis & silenced voices
Speaking	Scholarly discourse, panel, code-switching, spoken word & oral exam	9th Grade: Symposium leadership, capstone presentation & linguistic identity
Reading	Multiple lenses, power, intertextual project & exam mastery	9th Grade: Critical philosophy, ethical reading & capstone reading project
Writing	Critical theory essay, public writing, extended research & exam	9th Grade: Capstone critical essay, public portfolio & creative project

9th Grade

3rd Cycle | 24 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-9.1 *(Builds on L-8.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to independently evaluate the overall rhetorical effectiveness of a complex public address or intellectual talk, producing a structured critique that analyzes the interplay between ethos, pathos, and logos, and the limitations of the argument.
I Can	I can independently evaluate the rhetorical effectiveness of a complex speech or talk, writing or presenting a critique that analyzes how ethos, pathos, and logos work together and where the argument falls short.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)</i>	

L-9.2 *(Builds on L-8.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to representatives of competing intellectual traditions debate a complex issue and evaluate how each tradition's underlying assumptions shape not only conclusions reached but what questions are considered worth asking.
I Can	I can listen to people from competing intellectual traditions debate an issue and evaluate how their underlying assumptions shape not just their conclusions but the very questions they consider important.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)</i>	

L-9.3 *(Builds on L-8.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to analyze and evaluate the epistemic and democratic implications of contemporary media ecosystems — including filter bubbles, echo chambers, misinformation, and platform power — using specific examples from listened or viewed content.
I Can	I can analyze how contemporary media ecosystems affect what people believe and how democratic society functions, using specific examples from real media content to support my argument.
<i>Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

L-9.4 *(Builds on L-8.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to listen to a curated series of academic inputs on a complex interdisciplinary topic, synthesize the key arguments, tensions, and gaps across all sources, and use their synthesis as the foundation for a capstone contribution.
I Can	I can listen to a series of academic inputs on a complex topic, synthesize key arguments, tensions, and gaps, and use that synthesis as the basis for my own independently argued capstone contribution.
<i>Standards: 4 (Synthesize & Connect), 8 (Conduct Research)</i>	

L-9.5 *(Builds on L-8.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to analyze a collection of spoken or performed texts and evaluate whose voices are amplified, whose are silenced or distorted, and how the structural and aesthetic choices of each text challenge or reinforce power hierarchies.
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I Can	I can analyze a set of spoken or performed texts and evaluate which voices are amplified and which are silenced, and how the artistic choices in each text challenge or reinforce power hierarchies.
<i>Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)</i>	

L-9.6 <i>(Builds on L-8.6)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to perform at a high and consistent level across all secondary and internationally benchmarked exam listening formats, applying a personalized repertoire of listening strategies and demonstrating proficiency expected for the diversified cycle.
I Can	I can perform consistently well across all secondary exam listening formats, using my own personalized set of strategies, managing exam stress effectively, and demonstrating the proficiency needed for the diversified cycle.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

SPEAKING

S-9.1 <i>(Builds on S-8.1)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to demonstrate a fully developed independent scholarly voice in an academic debate or symposium, sustaining a complex, evidence-based position, responding to sophisticated challenges with nuanced reasoning, and modeling intellectual courage and humility simultaneously.
I Can	I can demonstrate my own independent scholarly voice in a debate or symposium, sustain a complex evidence-based position, respond to tough challenges with nuanced reasoning, and model both intellectual courage and genuine openness to changing my mind.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 3 (Evaluate & Critique)</i>	

S-9.2 <i>(Builds on S-8.2)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to design, organize, and lead a full academic symposium or community forum on a self-selected issue of social or intellectual significance, managing logistics, facilitating diverse contributions, and producing a public summary.
I Can	I can design, organize, and lead a full academic symposium or community forum on an issue I care about, facilitate diverse contributions, synthesize the group's insights, and produce a public summary.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

S-9.3 <i>(Builds on S-8.3)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to independently design, prepare, and deliver a capstone oral presentation of 15–20 minutes on a self-selected research topic to an authentic audience, demonstrating mastery of content, delivery, visual support, and audience management.
I Can	I can independently design and deliver a full capstone oral presentation of 15–20 minutes to a real audience, demonstrating mastery of my topic, confident delivery, effective visual support, and professional management of questions.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 8 (Conduct Research)</i>	

S-9.4 <i>(Builds on S-8.4)</i>	
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SWBAT	Students will be able to articulate a reflective and theoretically informed account of their own multilingual and multicultural identity, explaining how their linguistic repertoire shapes their thinking, relationships, and place in the world.
I Can	I can reflect deeply and articulate clearly how my multilingual and multicultural identity shapes how I think, how I relate to others, and how I understand my place in the world.
<i>Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

S-9.5 *(Builds on S-8.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to write, rehearse, and perform an original extended spoken word, slam poetry, or narrative performance piece engaging with a social, political, or personal theme of genuine significance, and lead a structured post-performance discussion.
I Can	I can write, rehearse, and perform an original extended performance piece on a theme that matters, demonstrating full mastery of performance craft, and lead a discussion with my audience about the ideas my performance raises.
<i>Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes)</i>	

S-9.6 *(Builds on S-8.6)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to perform at the highest secondary level across all oral examination formats — including prepared presentation, unprepared response, interactive discussion, and commentary on unseen material — demonstrating fluency, accuracy, coherence, and lexical range required for the diversified cycle.
I Can	I can perform at the highest level across all oral exam formats — prepared presentations, unseen material commentary, and interactive discussions — demonstrating the fluency, accuracy, and language range needed for the diversified cycle.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)</i>	

READING**R-9.1** *(Builds on R-8.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to synthesize their experience of applying multiple critical lenses into a personal critical reading philosophy — a reflective, theoretically informed statement articulating how they approach texts and how their critical framework will continue to develop.
I Can	I can synthesize what I have learned from applying multiple critical lenses and articulate my own personal critical reading philosophy — explaining how I approach texts, what I believe reading is for, and how I intend to keep developing.
<i>Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

R-9.2 *(Builds on R-8.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to conduct an independent ideological critique pairing a canonical literary text with a non-canonical or marginalized text on a related theme, analyzing how each text encodes and challenges dominant ideologies.
I Can	I can independently pair a canonical text with a non-canonical or marginalized text on a shared theme and conduct an ideological critique of both, analyzing how each encodes and challenges dominant ideologies.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts)</i>	

R-9.3 *(Builds on R-8.3)*

SWBAT Students will be able to design and independently complete a capstone reading research project — selecting a thematic or literary research question, curating a reading list of at least six texts, and producing an extended analytical synthesis.

I Can I can design and complete a capstone reading research project by selecting my own research question, curating a reading list of at least six texts, and writing an extended synthesis that draws on all of them.

Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)

R-9.4 *(Builds on R-8.4)*

SWBAT Students will be able to articulate and apply a framework for ethical reading — including practices of listening across difference, resisting appropriation, honoring complexity, and acknowledging the limits of their own interpretive perspective.

I Can I can articulate and practice ethical reading — listening respectfully across difference, honoring the complexity of experiences different from my own, avoiding appropriation, and acknowledging what I cannot fully understand from my own perspective.

Standards: 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

R-9.5 *(Builds on R-8.5)*

SWBAT Students will be able to reflect on and map their full reading journey across the secondary cycle — identifying texts that shaped their thinking, tracing critical reading skill development, and articulating a reading vision for the diversified cycle.

I Can I can map my reading journey across secondary school, identifying the texts that shaped me most as a thinker, tracing the growth of my critical reading skills, and articulating a vision and reading list for my final two years.

Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

R-9.6 *(Builds on R-8.6)*

SWBAT Students will be able to demonstrate reading proficiency at the level required for entry into the diversified cycle and internationally benchmarked assessments, performing consistently across all text types, question formats, and complexity levels.

I Can I can demonstrate reading proficiency at the level needed for the diversified cycle and international exams, performing consistently across all text types and question formats, and I can explain my own personalized exam strategy.

Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

 WRITING**W-9.1** *(Builds on W-8.1)*

SWBAT Students will be able to independently produce a capstone critical essay of 10–12 paragraphs representing their highest level of analytical and argumentative writing, applying a chosen critical framework with sophistication and positioning their contribution within existing critical conversation.

I Can	I can write a capstone critical essay that represents the best analytical writing I am capable of — applying a critical framework with sophistication, sustaining a fully developed original argument, and situating my ideas within the broader critical conversation.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

W-9.2 *(Builds on W-8.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to compile and publish an authentic public writing portfolio — comprising at least three polished pieces across different genres written for real audiences — accompanied by a curated artist's statement.
I Can	I can compile and publish a public writing portfolio of at least three polished pieces written for real audiences across different genres, and write an artist's statement reflecting on my choices, challenges, and growth.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

W-9.3 *(Builds on W-8.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to independently design, research, draft, revise, and publish a capstone research project of 12–15 paragraphs developing an original research question, synthesizing evidence from at least eight credible sources.
I Can	I can independently complete a full capstone research project — developing an original research question, synthesizing evidence from at least eight credible sources, maintaining full academic integrity, and presenting findings for an academic or public audience.
<i>Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)</i>	

W-9.4 *(Builds on W-8.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to produce a 3rd cycle capstone writing retrospective — a substantial reflective document curating their most significant writing, analyzing their development, critically evaluating strengths and limitations, and setting a writing agenda for the diversified cycle.
I Can	I can produce a capstone writing retrospective that gathers my most significant writing, analyzes my development honestly, evaluates my strengths and limitations, and sets a detailed writing agenda for my final two years.
<i>Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

W-9.5 *(Builds on W-8.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to conceive, develop, and complete an independent creative writing project of significant scope — demonstrating a fully realized personal voice, sustained thematic vision, sophisticated literary craft, and intentional engagement with a social or cultural theme.
I Can	I can conceive and complete an independent creative writing project of real scope and ambition — demonstrating a fully realized personal voice, a sustained thematic vision, sophisticated craft, and meaningful engagement with a social or cultural theme.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

W-9.6 *(Builds on W-8.6)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to produce exam-quality writing at the level required for the diversified cycle and internationally benchmarked assessments across all task types, and articulate a personalized exam writing strategy for the diversified cycle.
I Can	I can produce high-quality writing under timed exam conditions at the level required for the diversified cycle and international assessments, demonstrating mastery across all task types, and I can explain my own personalized exam writing strategy.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)</i>	

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Rhetorical mastery, epistemic media, capstone synthesis & exam readiness	10th Grade: Professional/civic rhetoric, university-level listening & listening ethics
Speaking	Symposium leadership, capstone presentation & full oral exam readiness	10th Grade: University discourse, cross-institutional facilitation & public performance
Reading	Critical philosophy, ethical reading, capstone project & exam readiness	10th Grade: Critical theory application, world literature & lifelong reading identity
Writing	Capstone essay, public portfolio, capstone research & full exam readiness	10th Grade: University-entry writing, professional identity & scholarly research

10th Grade

Diversified Cycle (4th Cycle) | 24 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-10.1 *(Builds on L-9.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to analyze and compare the rhetorical strategies deployed across three distinct discourse communities — academic, professional, and civic — examining how the conventions and power structures of each community shape what counts as persuasive speech.
I Can	I can analyze how rhetoric works differently across academic, professional, and civic contexts, examining how the conventions and power structures of each community determine what counts as persuasive and credible speech.
<i>Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)</i>	

L-10.2 *(Builds on L-9.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to engage productively with university-level academic lectures, talks, and recorded seminars — including content delivered at native-speaker pace with discipline-specific vocabulary — producing detailed, analytically organized notes.
I Can	I can engage with university-level academic talks delivered at full speed with specialized vocabulary, take detailed and analytically organized notes, and identify areas I need to research further.
<i>Standards: 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners), 8 (Conduct Research)</i>	

L-10.3 *(Builds on L-9.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to evaluate how listening practices — including selective listening, confirmation bias, and active critical engagement — shape democratic participation and civic life, arguing for disciplined, critical listening as a civic responsibility.
I Can	I can evaluate how the way people listen — or fail to listen — shapes democratic participation, and I can argue for why disciplined, critical listening is a civic responsibility using specific examples.
<i>Standards: 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

L-10.4 *(Builds on L-9.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to conduct sustained listening research across a range of academic and professional audio sources as part of an extended independent research project, synthesizing insights from listened sources alongside written sources.
I Can	I can use a wide range of academic and professional audio sources as part of my extended research project, synthesizing what I learn from listening alongside what I learn from reading, and documenting my research process clearly.
<i>Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)</i>	

L-10.5 *(Builds on L-9.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to articulate and demonstrate a personal listening ethics — a consciously developed set of principles for how they listen across difference, power, and cultural context — applying these in both academic and community settings.
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I Can	I can articulate my own personal listening ethics and demonstrate these principles in practice, reflecting on how they shape my relationships and responsibilities across academic and community settings.
<i>Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

L-10.6 <i>(Builds on L-9.6)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to perform at the level required for internationally benchmarked listening assessments (e.g., Cambridge, TOEFL, IELTS, IB) across all task formats, applying a refined and personalized exam strategy and self-evaluating performance.
I Can	I can perform at the level required for international listening exams across all task formats, using a refined personalized strategy, maintaining concentration over extended tasks, and honestly self-evaluating my performance.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	



SPEAKING

S-10.1 <i>(Builds on S-9.1)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to engage confidently and effectively in university-level academic discourse and professional discussion contexts, demonstrating command of disciplinary conventions, sustained argumentative coherence, and the ability to contribute original insight at a level appropriate for higher education.
I Can	I can engage confidently in university-level academic discussions and professional contexts, demonstrating command of disciplinary language, coherent argumentation, and the ability to contribute original insights at a level that prepares me for higher education.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

S-10.2 <i>(Builds on S-9.2)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to design and facilitate a cross-institutional or community-facing dialogue event, demonstrating professional-level facilitation skills, intercultural communication competency, and the ability to synthesize complex diverse contributions into actionable insights.
I Can	I can design and facilitate a cross-institutional or community dialogue event, demonstrating professional facilitation skills, intercultural communication competency, and the ability to synthesize diverse contributions into clear insights.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

S-10.3 <i>(Builds on S-9.3)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to deliver a professional-level independent research presentation of 15–20 minutes to an authentic audience, demonstrating mastery of academic content, sophisticated rhetorical strategy, polished delivery, and composure in complex audience engagement.
I Can	I can deliver a professional-level research presentation of 15–20 minutes, demonstrating mastery of my content, sophisticated rhetorical strategy, polished delivery, and the composure to handle complex audience questions.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

S-10.4 *(Builds on S-9.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to deliver a researched and persuasive spoken advocacy piece on the value of multilingualism and linguistic diversity, drawing on personal experience, academic research, and global examples, and inviting structured audience debate.
I Can	I can deliver a researched, persuasive spoken piece advocating for the value of multilingualism and linguistic diversity, drawing on my own experience, academic research, and global examples, and I can facilitate a discussion and debate afterward.

Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)

S-10.5 *(Builds on S-9.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to develop, rehearse, and deliver a fully realized public performance piece that demonstrates a distinctive, confident artistic voice, sophisticated command of performance craft, and a clear thematic and social vision.
I Can	I can develop and deliver a fully realized public performance piece with a distinctive artistic voice, sophisticated performance craft, and a clear social or thematic vision, presented to a real public audience.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

S-10.6 *(Builds on S-9.6)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to perform at the level required for internationally benchmarked oral examinations (e.g., Cambridge, IB, TOEFL, IELTS) across all task types, demonstrating the fluency, coherence, lexical range, and grammatical accuracy required for university entry.
I Can	I can perform at the level required for international oral exams across all task types, demonstrating the fluency, coherence, vocabulary range, and accuracy needed for university admission.

Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)

READING**R-10.1** *(Builds on R-9.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to apply a chosen critical theory systematically across a curated body of at least four texts, producing a sustained critical argument that demonstrates theoretical fluency, close textual engagement, and awareness of the theory's limitations.
I Can	I can apply a critical theory systematically across a body of at least four texts, writing a sustained argument that demonstrates theoretical fluency and honest awareness of what the theory cannot fully explain.

Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 2 (Analyze Craft & Structure)

R-10.2 *(Builds on R-9.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to engage in a sustained comparative study of world literature texts from at least three distinct cultural and linguistic traditions, analyzing how each text contributes to a global conversation on a shared theme.
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I Can	I can engage in a comparative study of world literature from at least three cultural traditions, analyzing how each text contributes to a global conversation on a shared theme and reflecting on the ethical responsibilities of reading across cultural difference.
<i>Standards: 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)</i>	

R-10.3 <i>(Builds on R-9.3)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to design and independently conduct an extended literary research project — formulating an original research question, selecting and critically evaluating a corpus of at least eight texts and scholarly sources.
I Can	I can design and conduct an extended literary research project, formulating an original research question, evaluating a corpus of at least eight texts and scholarly sources, and producing a substantial written response making an original contribution.
<i>Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 1 (Comprehend & Infer)</i>	

R-10.4 <i>(Builds on R-9.4)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to develop and sustain a reading practice that actively centers equity, justice, and underrepresented voices — curating a diverse reading list, engaging deeply with texts from marginalized traditions, and reflecting on their own reading biases.
I Can	I can develop and sustain a reading practice that actively centers equity and justice — curating a diverse reading list, engaging deeply with marginalized voices, and reflecting honestly on my own biases as a reader.
<i>Standards: 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

R-10.5 <i>(Builds on R-9.5)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to articulate a fully developed independent reading identity — including a reflective account of what reading means to them, a curated personal literary canon, commitments to ongoing development, and a vision for how reading will shape their life beyond school.
I Can	I can articulate my fully developed reading identity — what reading means to me, my personal literary canon, my commitments to ongoing development, and my vision for how reading will shape my intellectual and personal life beyond school.
<i>Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

R-10.6 <i>(Builds on R-9.6)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to perform at the level required for internationally benchmarked reading assessments across all text types and task formats, demonstrating sophisticated comprehension, literary analysis under timed conditions, and the ability to produce exam-quality extended written responses.
I Can	I can perform at the level required for international reading exams across all text types and formats, demonstrating sophisticated comprehension, literary analysis under timed conditions, and the ability to write high-quality extended responses.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

WRITING

W-10.1 *(Builds on W-9.1)*

SWBAT Students will be able to produce analytical and argumentative essays at the level expected for university entry — demonstrating a sophisticated original thesis, sustained analytical reasoning, seamless integration of evidence, consistent academic register, and awareness of the broader scholarly conversation.

I Can I can write analytical and argumentative essays at university entry level — with a sophisticated original thesis, sustained reasoning, seamless evidence integration, consistent academic register, and awareness of the scholarly conversation my essay contributes to.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 9 (Use Evidence)

W-10.2 *(Builds on W-9.2)*

SWBAT Students will be able to develop a professional writing identity — including a curated public portfolio, a personal statement of writing philosophy, and at least two pieces submitted or prepared for submission to authentic external audiences.

I Can I can develop a professional writing identity — curating a public portfolio, articulating my writing philosophy, and producing at least two pieces prepared for authentic external audiences such as a literary magazine or university application.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

W-10.3 *(Builds on W-9.3)*

SWBAT Students will be able to independently produce a scholarly research paper of 15–18 paragraphs developing a significant original research question, synthesizing evidence from at least ten credible sources, and presenting findings at a level appropriate for academic journal or university seminar submission.

I Can I can independently write a scholarly research paper with a significant original research question, synthesizing evidence from at least ten credible multidisciplinary sources at a level appropriate for academic journal or university seminar submission.

Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)

W-10.4 *(Builds on W-9.4)*

SWBAT Students will be able to produce a detailed diversified cycle writing development plan — evaluating their current writing strengths and limitations, setting specific and measurable goals for 10th and 11th grade, and articulating how strong writing will serve their academic and professional aspirations.

I Can I can produce a detailed writing development plan for the diversified cycle — honestly evaluating my current strengths and limitations, setting specific measurable goals, and explaining how strong writing will serve my future academic and professional life.

Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

W-10.5 *(Builds on W-9.5)*

SWBAT Students will be able to develop and sustain an intentional creative writing practice across the year — producing a body of creative work across at least two genres, engaging in regular craft reflection, participating in peer workshop processes, and producing a final polished piece with craft commentary.

I Can	I can develop and sustain a creative writing practice across the year — building a body of work across at least two genres, reflecting regularly on my craft, workshoping with peers, and producing a final polished piece with a craft commentary.
<i>Standards: 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

W-10.6 <i>(Builds on W-9.6)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to produce exam-quality writing at the level required for internationally benchmarked assessments across all task types, demonstrating consistent mastery and self-evaluating each practice response against exam band descriptors.
I Can	I can produce exam-quality writing across all internationally benchmarked task types under timed conditions, demonstrating consistent mastery of task requirements, and honestly self-evaluating each practice response against exam band descriptors.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)</i>	

Scaffolding Roadmap

Skill	This Grade Consolidates...	Next Grade Builds Toward...
Listening	Professional/civic rhetoric, university listening, listening ethics & international exam	11th Grade: Mastery of critical listening, civic manifesto & lifelong listening practice
Speaking	University discourse, cross-institutional facilitation, public performance & international exam	11th Grade: Full mastery, public leadership, capstone presentation & peak oral exam
Reading	Critical theory application, world literature, equity reading & international exam	11th Grade: Full mastery, world literature canon, capstone project & reading legacy
Writing	University-entry writing, professional identity, scholarly research & international exam	11th Grade: Full mastery, public portfolio, capstone research & writing legacy

11th Grade

Diversified Cycle (4th Cycle) | 24 objectives objectives total | ESL Expectations

LISTENING

L-11.1 *(Builds on L-10.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to demonstrate mastery-level critical listening across professional, academic, and civic contexts — analyzing rhetorical strategies, evaluating argument quality, detecting bias and manipulation, and articulating how disciplined critical listening contributes to their effectiveness as a communicator and citizen.
I Can	I can demonstrate mastery-level critical listening across professional, academic, and civic contexts — analyzing rhetoric, evaluating arguments, detecting bias, and articulating how disciplined listening makes me a more effective communicator, citizen, and lifelong learner.

Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 13 (Evaluate Spoken Content)

L-11.2 *(Builds on L-10.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to engage independently and effectively with a full range of university-level and professional academic inputs, producing high-quality notes, critical annotations, and analytical summaries that demonstrate readiness for post-secondary academic life.
I Can	I can independently engage with university-level and professional academic content across formats, producing high-quality notes and analytical summaries that demonstrate full comprehension and critical engagement and show I am ready for post-secondary life.

Standards: 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners), 4 (Synthesize & Connect)

L-11.3 *(Builds on L-10.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to produce and publicly present a personal civic listening manifesto — a carefully argued, evidence-based document articulating their commitments to critical, empathetic, and equitable listening as a citizen.
I Can	I can write and publicly present a personal civic listening manifesto — a carefully argued document that articulates my commitments to critical, empathetic, and equitable listening as a citizen, drawing on research and real-world examples.

Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)

L-11.4 *(Builds on L-10.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to demonstrate that listening is a fully integrated component of their scholarly practice — documenting how audio and spoken sources contributed to their capstone research project and articulating a vision for continuing to learn through listening beyond school.
I Can	I can demonstrate that listening is a fully integrated part of how I do research — documenting how spoken sources contributed to my capstone project and articulating how I will continue to learn through listening after school.

Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

L-11.5 *(Builds on L-10.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to model and advocate for ethical listening practices in their school, community, and civic life — demonstrating through their own behavior and structured advocacy the principles of listening across difference and listening as an act of respect and solidarity.
I Can	I can model and advocate for ethical listening in my school, community, and civic life — demonstrating through my own behavior and advocacy how to listen across difference, amplify marginalized voices, and practice listening as genuine respect and solidarity.
<i>Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

L-11.6 *(Builds on L-10.6)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to perform at their personal peak level in internationally benchmarked listening examinations, applying a fully refined and personalized exam strategy, and producing a substantive post-exam reflection capturing lessons for future high-stakes listening contexts.
I Can	I can perform at my personal best in international listening exams, applying a fully refined strategy, performing consistently across all task types, and reflecting substantively on my performance to extract lessons for future contexts.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

**SPEAKING****S-11.1** *(Builds on S-10.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to demonstrate full mastery of academic and professional oral communication — engaging with authority, clarity, and intellectual confidence across seminars, debates, presentations, interviews, and professional discussions.
I Can	I can demonstrate full mastery of academic and professional communication across all contexts — seminars, debates, presentations, and interviews — and I can articulate clearly how my communicative skills will serve my future academic and professional life.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue)</i>	

S-11.2 *(Builds on S-10.2)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to design and lead a public-facing dialogue initiative on a significant social, cultural, or intellectual issue, demonstrating professional leadership, inclusive facilitation, and the ability to turn diverse public dialogue into meaningful community insight and action.
I Can	I can design and lead a public dialogue initiative on a significant issue — demonstrating professional leadership, inclusive facilitation, and the ability to transform diverse public conversation into meaningful insight and community action.
<i>Standards: 11 (Engage in Collaborative Dialogue), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

S-11.3 *(Builds on S-10.3)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to deliver a fully realized public capstone presentation — representing the culmination of their secondary English education — that synthesizes their most significant intellectual, creative, and personal growth and articulates a compelling vision for their future.
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I Can	I can deliver a fully realized public capstone presentation that synthesizes the most significant intellectual, creative, and personal growth of my secondary education, demonstrates mastery of content and communication, and articulates a clear, compelling vision for my future.
<i>Standards: 12 (Present Ideas Effectively), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)</i>	

S-11.4 *(Builds on S-10.4)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to act as a multilingual ambassador and language rights advocate within their school and community — designing awareness initiatives, mentoring younger learners, and producing a public-facing advocacy campaign for linguistic diversity.
I Can	I can act as a multilingual ambassador and advocate for language rights in my school and community — designing awareness initiatives, mentoring younger learners, and producing a public advocacy campaign for linguistic diversity and bilingual education.
<i>Standards: 17 (Explore Identity & Culture), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)</i>	

S-11.5 *(Builds on S-10.5)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to develop and present a fully realized spoken artistic portfolio — comprising a curated selection of original performance pieces — alongside a public artist's statement reflecting on their artistic development, thematic preoccupations, and creative vision beyond school.
I Can	I can present a fully realized spoken artistic portfolio — a curated collection of original performance pieces — and deliver a public artist's statement that reflects on my artistic development, my themes, and my creative vision beyond school.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

S-11.6 *(Builds on S-10.6)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to perform at their personal peak level in internationally benchmarked oral examinations, demonstrating the fluency, coherence, lexical range, grammatical accuracy, and rhetorical sophistication required for the highest band descriptors.
I Can	I can perform at my personal best in international oral exams, demonstrating the fluency, coherence, vocabulary range, accuracy, and rhetorical sophistication needed for the highest exam bands, and reflect on what this has taught me about myself as a communicator.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 12 (Present Ideas Effectively)</i>	

READING**R-11.1** *(Builds on R-10.1)*

SWBAT	Students will be able to demonstrate a fully developed, theoretically sophisticated, and personally distinctive critical reading practice — applying multiple critical frameworks with fluency and selectivity, producing original analytical arguments, and articulating how their critical reading will continue beyond school.
I Can	I can demonstrate a fully developed and distinctive critical reading practice — applying critical frameworks fluently and selectively, producing original arguments that genuinely engage with the texts I read, and articulating how I will continue to develop as a critical reader beyond school.

Standards: 3 (Evaluate & Critique), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

R-11.2 *(Builds on R-10.2)*

SWBAT Students will be able to curate and publicly present a personal world literature canon — a carefully selected and critically justified collection of texts from diverse global traditions — and defend their canonical choices in a structured academic discussion.

I Can I can curate and publicly present my personal world literature canon — a carefully selected collection of texts from diverse global traditions that reflects my literary values — and defend my choices in a structured academic discussion.

Standards: 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

R-11.3 *(Builds on R-10.3)*

SWBAT Students will be able to independently produce a capstone scholarly reading and research contribution making an original, well-argued, and fully evidenced contribution to a literary or humanities research question, at a level appropriate for university first-year study.

I Can I can independently produce a capstone scholarly research contribution that represents my highest level of academic work — making an original, well-argued, fully evidenced contribution at a level appropriate for university first-year study.

Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 9 (Use Evidence)

R-11.4 *(Builds on R-10.4)*

SWBAT Students will be able to act as a reading advocate and literary community builder within their school — designing and leading initiatives that promote diverse, inclusive, and equity-centered reading culture and reflecting on the social and ethical dimensions of their advocacy.

I Can I can act as a reading advocate and literary community builder in my school — designing and leading initiatives that promote diverse and inclusive reading culture, and reflecting on the social and ethical dimensions of advocating for reading as a tool for justice and empathy.

Standards: 5 (Engage with Diverse & Heritage Texts), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

R-11.5 *(Builds on R-10.5)*

SWBAT Students will be able to write and present a reading legacy statement — articulating what reading has meant to them across their schooling, how it has shaped who they are as a thinker, person, and citizen, and what their commitments to reading and intellectual life will be beyond school.

I Can I can write and present a reading legacy statement — articulating what reading has meant to me across my schooling, how it has shaped who I am as a thinker and citizen, and what my commitments to reading and intellectual life will be beyond school.

Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)

R-11.6 *(Builds on R-10.6)*

SWBAT Students will be able to perform at their personal peak level in internationally benchmarked reading examinations and produce a final reading exam reflection capturing what they have learned about themselves as readers and how they will carry those insights into post-secondary life.

I Can	I can perform at my personal best in international reading exams across all formats, and I can write a final reflection on what I have learned about myself as a reader and how I will carry those insights into life beyond school.
<i>Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)</i>	

WRITING

W-11.1 <i>(Builds on W-10.1)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to produce fully realized independent scholarly writing at the level expected for university first-year study — demonstrating an authoritative and distinctive academic voice, mastery of argumentation and evidence integration, and the intellectual confidence to make original contributions.
I Can	I can produce fully realized scholarly writing at university first-year level — with an authoritative and distinctive academic voice, mastery of argumentation and evidence, and the intellectual confidence to make original contributions to scholarly conversations.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 9 (Use Evidence)</i>	

W-11.2 <i>(Builds on W-10.2)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to establish a fully realized and publicly visible writing presence — through a curated public portfolio, at least three pieces published or submitted to authentic external audiences, and a personal writing manifesto articulating their values and vision for writing as lifelong practice.
I Can	I can establish a publicly visible writing presence — through a curated portfolio, at least three pieces published or submitted to real audiences, and a personal writing manifesto articulating my values, aesthetic commitments, and vision for writing as lifelong practice.
<i>Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 17 (Explore Identity & Culture)</i>	

W-11.3 <i>(Builds on W-10.3)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to independently produce a fully realized capstone research publication representing the highest level of academic writing of their secondary career, making a significant original contribution at a level appropriate for university submission, academic competition, or youth research publication.
I Can	I can independently produce a capstone research publication — the highest level of academic writing I have achieved — making a significant original contribution at a level appropriate for university submission, academic competition, or youth publication.
<i>Standards: 8 (Conduct Research), 10 (Apply Technical Conventions)</i>	

W-11.4 <i>(Builds on W-10.4)</i>	
SWBAT	Students will be able to produce a comprehensive writing legacy statement and post-secondary writing vision — reflecting on the full arc of their development as a writer, honestly evaluating who they are as a writer at graduation, and articulating an ambitious vision for their writing life beyond school.
I Can	I can produce a comprehensive writing legacy statement that reflects on my full development as a writer from my earliest years to graduation, honestly evaluates who I am as a writer right now, and articulates a clear and ambitious vision for my writing life beyond school.

Standards: 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections), 18 (Develop as Critical & Competent Learners)

W-11.5 *(Builds on W-10.5)*

SWBAT Students will be able to complete, polish, and present a fully realized creative writing legacy project — a substantial, cohesive body of original creative work — accompanied by a public artist's statement, a craft essay, and a live or recorded public performance or reading.

I Can I can complete and present a fully realized creative writing legacy project — a cohesive body of my finest original work — accompanied by a public artist's statement, a craft essay on my development and philosophy, and a live or recorded public reading.

Standards: 6 (Write for a Range of Purposes), 16 (Make Personal & Metacognitive Connections)

W-11.6 *(Builds on W-10.6)*

SWBAT Students will be able to perform at their personal peak level in internationally benchmarked writing examinations — demonstrating mastery across all task types at the highest band descriptor level — and produce a final writing exam reflection capturing what they have learned as writers.

I Can I can perform at my personal best in international writing exams across all task types at the highest band level, and I can write a final reflection on what I have learned about myself as a writer and how I will carry my writing practice into life beyond school.

Standards: 19 (Develop Effective Test-Taking Strategies), 7 (Develop & Strengthen Writing)

Part 4: Vertical Alignment by Skill

How each skill scaffolds from Prekinder through 11th Grade

VERTICAL ALIGNMENT: LISTENING

All Listening objectives from Prekinder through 11th Grade, showing the continuous scaffold of skill development.

Grade	Listening Objectives
Prekinder	L-PK.1 Students will be able to show understanding of a single spoken word or simple command (e.g., 'sit,' 'clap,' 'look') by r... L-PK.2 Students will be able to recognize their own name and the names of 2–3 classmates when spoken aloud in a group setting.
Kinder	L-K.1 Students will be able to follow two-step oral instructions given by the teacher using familiar classroom language and vi... L-K.2 Students will be able to identify the main subject of a short spoken text (e.g., a simple song, chant, or read-aloud) by...
Prepa	L-PP.1 Students will be able to identify at least two key details (e.g., who, what, where) from a short read-aloud or spoken te... L-PP.2 Students will be able to recognize the sequence of two or three events in a short listened story by ordering picture car...
1st Grade	L-1.1 Students will be able to identify the main idea and at least two supporting details from a short read-aloud or listened ... L-1.2 Students will be able to retell the beginning, middle, and end of a short listened story using sequencing words (e.g., '...' L-1.3 Students will be able to infer the meaning of an unfamiliar word heard in a short spoken text by using context clues suc...
2nd Grade	L-2.1 Students will be able to make a simple inference about a character's feelings or a speaker's purpose by listening to a s... L-2.2 Students will be able to listen to a short informational text or classroom explanation and distinguish between key infor... L-2.3 Students will be able to listen to a classmate's short oral presentation and identify one thing that was communicated cl...
3rd Grade	L-3.1 Students will be able to identify the speaker's point of view in a short listened text and explain whether the informati... L-3.2 Students will be able to listen to two short spoken texts on the same topic and identify one idea they share and one way... L-3.3 Students will be able to listen to a peer's oral presentation and provide structured constructive feedback using a feedb...
4th Grade	L-4.1 Students will be able to listen to a short informational talk or recorded speech and evaluate whether the speaker's clai... L-4.2 Students will be able to listen to two or three short spoken texts on a related topic and organize the key ideas from ea... L-4.3 Students will be able to evaluate a peer's or recorded speaker's oral presentation using a structured rubric that addres... L-4.4 Students will be able to apply active listening strategies (e.g., mental summarizing, asking clarifying questions, conne...
5th Grade	L-5.1 Students will be able to identify implicit messages and rhetorical techniques (e.g., repetition, emotional appeal, load... L-5.2 Students will be able to listen to multiple perspectives on a controversial topic presented in a discussion or recorded ... L-5.3 Students will be able to critically evaluate a short video, podcast, or multimedia presentation for credibility, bias, a... L-5.4 Students will be able to listen to an academic lecture or content-area explanation of 3–5 minutes and produce organized ...
6th Grade	L-6.1 Students will be able to evaluate the strength and logic of a complex argument heard in an academic discussion, recorded...

Grade	Listening Objectives
	L-6.2 Students will be able to listen to an extended academic discussion or panel debate, synthesize the key positions and sup... L-6.3 Students will be able to compare how two different media sources frame the same topic or event, analyzing differences in... L-6.4 Students will be able to listen to a series of academic inputs on a research topic, synthesize notes from all sources in...
7th Grade	L-7.1 Students will be able to analyze the rhetorical strategies (e.g., ethos, pathos, logos) used in a speech, podcast, or ac... L-7.2 Students will be able to listen to an academic discussion or recorded scholarly talk and evaluate the quality of reasoni... L-7.3 Students will be able to analyze how language, visuals, and editorial choices in two or more media texts construct a par... L-7.4 Students will be able to listen to extended academic content across subject areas and produce discipline-appropriate not... L-7.5 Students will be able to identify subtext and implied meaning in a performed or recorded dramatic or literary text, expl... L-7.6 Students will be able to apply specific listening comprehension strategies in a timed, exam-style context — including pr...
8th Grade	L-8.1 Students will be able to compare the use of rhetorical strategies across two speeches or talks from different cultural o... L-8.2 Students will be able to listen to a scholarly or intellectual argument and identify the underlying ideological assumpti... L-8.3 Students will be able to evaluate the media literacy implications of a digital content piece, analyzing how algorithm-dr... L-8.4 Students will be able to listen to two or more academic sources that present conflicting information and produce a synth... L-8.5 Students will be able to analyze how voice, perspective, and power dynamics are constructed in a spoken narrative or dra... L-8.6 Students will be able to demonstrate proficiency across a range of complex exam-style listening tasks — including multip...
9th Grade	L-9.1 Students will be able to independently evaluate the overall rhetorical effectiveness of a complex public address or inte... L-9.2 Students will be able to listen to representatives of competing intellectual traditions debate a complex issue and evalu... L-9.3 Students will be able to analyze and evaluate the epistemic and democratic implications of contemporary media ecosystems... L-9.4 Students will be able to listen to a curated series of academic inputs on a complex interdisciplinary topic, synthesize ... L-9.5 Students will be able to analyze a collection of spoken or performed texts and evaluate whose voices are amplified, whos... L-9.6 Students will be able to perform at a high and consistent level across all secondary and internationally benchmarked exa...
10th Grade	L-10.1 Students will be able to analyze and compare the rhetorical strategies deployed across three distinct discourse communit... L-10.2 Students will be able to engage productively with university-level academic lectures, talks, and recorded seminars — inc... L-10.3 Students will be able to evaluate how listening practices — including selective listening, confirmation bias, and active... L-10.4 Students will be able to conduct sustained listening research across a range of academic and professional audio sources ... L-10.5 Students will be able to articulate and demonstrate a personal listening ethics — a consciously developed set of princip... L-10.6 Students will be able to perform at the level required for internationally benchmarked listening assessments (e.g., Camb...
11th Grade	L-11.1 Students will be able to demonstrate mastery-level critical listening across professional, academic, and civic contexts ...

Grade	Listening Objectives
	L-11.2 Students will be able to engage independently and effectively with a full range of university-level and professional aca... L-11.3 Students will be able to produce and publicly present a personal civic listening manifesto — a carefully argued, evidenc... L-11.4 Students will be able to demonstrate that listening is a fully integrated component of their scholarly practice — docume... L-11.5 Students will be able to model and advocate for ethical listening practices in their school, community, and civic life —... L-11.6 Students will be able to perform at their personal peak level in internationally benchmarked listening examinations, app...

VERTICAL ALIGNMENT: SPEAKING

All Speaking objectives from Prekinder through 11th Grade, showing the continuous scaffold of skill development.

Grade	Speaking Objectives
Prekinder	S-PK.1 Students will be able to repeat single words and simple phrases modeled by the teacher, such as color names, numbers 1–5... S-PK.2 Students will be able to use a single English word or gesture to express a basic need or feeling in the classroom (e.g.,...
Kinder	S-K.1 Students will be able to name at least 15 familiar classroom and household objects, animals, and colors using single wor... S-K.2 Students will be able to participate in a simple two-turn exchange with a classmate or teacher using a modeled sentence ...
Prepa	S-PP.1 Students will be able to describe a familiar person, animal, or object using at least one adjective and one noun in a sh... S-PP.2 Students will be able to share a personal preference or simple idea in English using a sentence frame (e.g., 'I like ____...
1st Grade	S-1.1 Students will be able to describe a familiar person, place, or object using a complete sentence that includes a subject,... S-1.2 Students will be able to participate in a short structured conversation of 3–4 turns with a partner, using learned sente... S-1.3 Students will be able to present 3–4 sentences about a personally meaningful topic to a small group, speaking audibly an...
2nd Grade	S-2.1 Students will be able to state a simple opinion about a familiar topic and support it with at least one reason, using se... S-2.2 Students will be able to engage in an extended conversation of 5–6 turns with a partner, using language to agree, disagr... S-2.3 Students will be able to deliver a short prepared oral presentation of 5–6 sentences to the whole class on a familiar to...
3rd Grade	S-3.1 Students will be able to state a clear opinion on a familiar topic and support it with two or three reasons, using trans... S-3.2 Students will be able to respond to a classmate's opinion by acknowledging their point of view, agreeing or respectfully... S-3.3 Students will be able to deliver a rehearsed oral report of 6–8 sentences on a self-selected or assigned topic, organizi...
4th Grade	S-4.1 Students will be able to present a persuasive argument on a familiar topic that includes a clear position, three support... S-4.2 Students will be able to take an active role in a small group discussion by contributing ideas, inviting quieter members... S-4.3 Students will be able to deliver a prepared presentation of 8–10 sentences supported by a visual aid, speaking clearly, ... S-4.4 Students will be able to distinguish between informal and formal spoken language and demonstrate the ability to adjust t...
5th Grade	S-5.1 Students will be able to participate in a formal structured debate, presenting an assigned position with at least three ... S-5.2 Students will be able to lead or co-lead a Socratic seminar-style discussion on a text or topic, posing open-ended quest... S-5.3 Students will be able to deliver a research-based presentation of 10–12 sentences that incorporates data, quotes, or sta... S-5.4 Students will be able to demonstrate consistent use of academic vocabulary and formal register in classroom discussions,...
6th Grade	S-6.1 Students will be able to independently research and present a position on a complex topic in a formal academic context, ... S-6.2 Students will be able to facilitate a structured collaborative inquiry discussion on a complex text or issue, designing ... S-6.3 Students will be able to deliver a polished capstone-style oral presentation of 12–15 minutes on an independently resear...

Grade	Speaking Objectives
	S-6.4 Students will be able to demonstrate flexible and confident command of formal academic English across a range of speakin...
7th Grade	S-7.1 Students will be able to construct and orally defend a nuanced academic argument on a complex topic, anticipating and ad... S-7.2 Students will be able to lead an academic discussion that models intellectual humility — acknowledging uncertainty, revi... S-7.3 Students will be able to prepare and deliver an independently designed academic seminar contribution of 10–15 minutes on... S-7.4 Students will be able to deploy discipline-specific vocabulary and discourse conventions appropriate to at least two sub... S-7.5 Students will be able to deliver a structured personal reflection of 5–7 minutes exploring their own cultural identity, ... S-7.6 Students will be able to prepare for and perform in a structured oral examination or speaking assessment, demonstrating ...
8th Grade	S-8.1 Students will be able to engage in high-level intellectual discourse on a complex academic topic, sustaining a position ... S-8.2 Students will be able to facilitate a complex academic discussion that incorporates diverse cultural and ideological per... S-8.3 Students will be able to co-design and deliver a collaborative academic panel or symposium-style presentation with peers... S-8.4 Students will be able to consciously code-switch between formal academic English and their own personal or cultural voic... S-8.5 Students will be able to write and perform an original spoken word piece, personal essay reading, or narrative monologue... S-8.6 Students will be able to perform at a high level in a formal oral examination or speaking assessment, demonstrating flue...
9th Grade	S-9.1 Students will be able to demonstrate a fully developed independent scholarly voice in an academic debate or symposium, s... S-9.2 Students will be able to design, organize, and lead a full academic symposium or community forum on a self-selected issu... S-9.3 Students will be able to independently design, prepare, and deliver a capstone oral presentation of 15–20 minutes on a s... S-9.4 Students will be able to articulate a reflective and theoretically informed account of their own multilingual and multic... S-9.5 Students will be able to write, rehearse, and perform an original extended spoken word, slam poetry, or narrative perfor... S-9.6 Students will be able to perform at the highest secondary level across all oral examination formats — including prepared...
10th Grade	S-10.1 Students will be able to engage confidently and effectively in university-level academic discourse and professional disc... S-10.2 Students will be able to design and facilitate a cross-institutional or community-facing dialogue event, demonstrating p... S-10.3 Students will be able to deliver a professional-level independent research presentation of 15–20 minutes to an authentic... S-10.4 Students will be able to deliver a researched and persuasive spoken advocacy piece on the value of multilingualism and l... S-10.5 Students will be able to develop, rehearse, and deliver a fully realized public performance piece that demonstrates a di... S-10.6 Students will be able to perform at the level required for internationally benchmarked oral examinations (e.g., Cambridg...
11th Grade	S-11.1 Students will be able to demonstrate full mastery of academic and professional oral communication — engaging with author... S-11.2 Students will be able to design and lead a public-facing dialogue initiative on a significant social, cultural, or intel... S-11.3 Students will be able to deliver a fully realized public capstone presentation — representing the culmination of their s...

Grade	Speaking Objectives
	S-11.4 Students will be able to act as a multilingual ambassador and language rights advocate within their school and community... S-11.5 Students will be able to develop and present a fully realized spoken artistic portfolio — comprising a curated selection... S-11.6 Students will be able to perform at their personal peak level in internationally benchmarked oral examinations, demonstr...

VERTICAL ALIGNMENT: READING

All Reading objectives from Prekinder through 11th Grade, showing the continuous scaffold of skill development.

Grade	Reading Objectives
Prekinder	R-PK.1 Students will be able to recognize that printed text carries meaning by pointing to words and pictures in a big book or ... R-PK.2 Students will be able to identify and name at least 8 letters of the English alphabet (uppercase), particularly those in...
Kinder	R-K.1 Students will be able to recognize and name all 26 uppercase and most lowercase letters of the English alphabet, and ide... R-K.2 Students will be able to use picture clues and repeated text patterns in a simple illustrated book to predict or 'read a...
Prepa	R-PP.1 Students will be able to decode simple CVC words (e.g., cat, sit, hop) and recognize a set of up to 15 high-frequency si... R-PP.2 Students will be able to identify the main character and at least one key event in a simple illustrated story, respondin...
1st Grade	R-1.1 Students will be able to decode CVC and simple CCVC words and recognize a set of up to 30 high-frequency sight words, re... R-1.2 Students will be able to identify the main character, setting, problem, and solution in a simple illustrated story, resp... R-1.3 Students will be able to make a simple text-to-self connection after reading or listening to a story, explaining how a c...
2nd Grade	R-2.1 Students will be able to read a short leveled text aloud with developing fluency, attending to punctuation cues for phra... R-2.2 Students will be able to make a simple inference about why a character behaves a certain way, supporting their answer wi... R-2.3 Students will be able to make a text-to-world connection by identifying how the events or ideas in a story relate to som...
3rd Grade	R-3.1 Students will be able to apply at least two reading comprehension strategies (e.g., visualizing, questioning, re-reading... R-3.2 Students will be able to identify the central theme or lesson of a story and compare how two characters from the same or... R-3.3 Students will be able to read two short texts from different cultural contexts and identify how the perspectives, values...
4th Grade	R-4.1 Students will be able to independently select and apply appropriate reading comprehension strategies when reading both f... R-4.2 Students will be able to identify the author's purpose in a given text and explain how specific literary devices (e.g., ... R-4.3 Students will be able to analyze how the cultural background or context of a text influences its characters, themes, or ... R-4.4 Students will be able to read an extended leveled text independently over a sustained period and demonstrate comprehensi...
5th Grade	R-5.1 Students will be able to critically read an informational or persuasive text, distinguishing between fact and opinion, i... R-5.2 Students will be able to write or present a structured literary analysis of a short story or novel excerpt, examining ho... R-5.3 Students will be able to compare two texts from different cultural or historical contexts, analyzing how each reflects t... R-5.4 Students will be able to read an independently chosen novel or extended text and produce an analytical reading response ...
6th Grade	R-6.1 Students will be able to conduct a close reading of a complex informational or argumentative text, annotating for main c... R-6.2 Students will be able to write an independent literary critique of a complete short story or novel excerpt, analyzing ho... R-6.3 Students will be able to read and respond to a curated selection of texts from diverse global, cultural, and linguistic ...

Grade	Reading Objectives
	R-6.4 Students will be able to design and complete a self-directed independent reading project — selecting a text, setting rea...
7th Grade	R-7.1 Students will be able to conduct a sustained close reading of a complex literary or non-literary text, annotating for di... R-7.2 Students will be able to identify and analyze the philosophical, ideological, or cultural perspective embedded in a lite... R-7.3 Students will be able to read texts across at least three genres on a shared thematic topic and synthesize insights acro... R-7.4 Students will be able to independently select and read an extended text through the lens of a critical framework (e.g., ... R-7.5 Students will be able to identify and analyze intertextual connections between two or more texts — including allusions, ... R-7.6 Students will be able to apply exam-specific reading strategies (e.g., skimming for gist, scanning for detail, managing ...
8th Grade	R-8.1 Students will be able to apply two or more critical reading lenses (e.g., feminist, postcolonial, Marxist, psychological... R-8.2 Students will be able to analyze how power relationships and ideological positions are encoded in the language of a lite... R-8.3 Students will be able to design and complete an extended intertextual reading project that traces a theme, motif, or soc... R-8.4 Students will be able to reflect on how their own social position, cultural background, and prior experiences influence ... R-8.5 Students will be able to situate a literary text within its broader literary and cultural tradition, identifying the con... R-8.6 Students will be able to demonstrate consistent mastery across a full range of secondary-level exam reading tasks — incl...
9th Grade	R-9.1 Students will be able to synthesize their experience of applying multiple critical lenses into a personal critical readi... R-9.2 Students will be able to conduct an independent ideological critique pairing a canonical literary text with a non-canoni... R-9.3 Students will be able to design and independently complete a capstone reading research project — selecting a thematic or... R-9.4 Students will be able to articulate and apply a framework for ethical reading — including practices of listening across ... R-9.5 Students will be able to reflect on and map their full reading journey across the secondary cycle — identifying texts th... R-9.6 Students will be able to demonstrate reading proficiency at the level required for entry into the diversified cycle and ...
10th Grade	R-10.1 Students will be able to apply a chosen critical theory systematically across a curated body of at least four texts, pro... R-10.2 Students will be able to engage in a sustained comparative study of world literature texts from at least three distinct ... R-10.3 Students will be able to design and independently conduct an extended literary research project — formulating an origina... R-10.4 Students will be able to develop and sustain a reading practice that actively centers equity, justice, and underrepresen... R-10.5 Students will be able to articulate a fully developed independent reading identity — including a reflective account of w... R-10.6 Students will be able to perform at the level required for internationally benchmarked reading assessments across all te...
11th Grade	R-11.1 Students will be able to demonstrate a fully developed, theoretically sophisticated, and personally distinctive critical... R-11.2 Students will be able to curate and publicly present a personal world literature canon — a carefully selected and critic... R-11.3 Students will be able to independently produce a capstone scholarly reading and research contribution making an original...

Grade	Reading Objectives
	R-11.4 Students will be able to act as a reading advocate and literary community builder within their school — designing and le... R-11.5 Students will be able to write and present a reading legacy statement — articulating what reading has meant to them acro... R-11.6 Students will be able to perform at their personal peak level in internationally benchmarked reading examinations and pr...

VERTICAL ALIGNMENT: WRITING

All Writing objectives from Prekinder through 11th Grade, showing the continuous scaffold of skill development.

Grade	Writing Objectives
Prekinder	W-PK.1 Students will be able to demonstrate pre-writing readiness by drawing controlled shapes (lines, circles, crosses) and ho... W-PK.2 Students will be able to attempt to write or trace the letters of their own first name, producing at least the first let...
Kinder	W-K.1 Students will be able to write their full first name independently using recognizable uppercase and lowercase letters wi... W-K.2 Students will be able to copy a modeled word of 3–4 letters and use it to label a drawing, demonstrating left-to-right d...
Prepa	W-PP.1 Students will be able to write a simple two- to three-word sentence using a subject and verb, with support from a word b... W-PP.2 Students will be able to produce a simple personal sentence about themselves (e.g., 'I am ____.' / 'I like ____.') accompa...
1st Grade	W-1.1 Students will be able to write 2–3 connected sentences on a familiar topic using a sentence frame scaffold, demonstratin... W-1.2 Students will be able to write a short personal narrative of 3–4 sentences about a real experience, including who was in... W-1.3 Students will be able to apply basic writing conventions including capitalization of the first word in a sentence and pr...
2nd Grade	W-2.1 Students will be able to write a structured paragraph of 4–5 sentences that includes a topic sentence, two or three supp... W-2.2 Students will be able to write a descriptive narrative of 4–5 sentences about a personal experience or imagined event, i... W-2.3 Students will be able to review and edit their own writing for correct capitalization, end punctuation, and spelling of ...
3rd Grade	W-3.1 Students will be able to write a structured multi-paragraph text (3 paragraphs) that includes an introductory paragraph ... W-3.2 Students will be able to write a structured opinion piece of 3–4 paragraphs that clearly states a position, provides two... W-3.3 Students will be able to conduct a simple guided research task using two provided sources, take brief notes in their own...
4th Grade	W-4.1 Students will be able to write a structured 5-paragraph essay that includes an introduction with a clear thesis statemen... W-4.2 Students will be able to write a persuasive essay of 4–5 paragraphs that presents a clear argument, supports it with at ... W-4.3 Students will be able to conduct an independent research task using three or more sources, take organized notes using th... W-4.4 Students will be able to apply the full writing process — planning, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing — incorp...
5th Grade	W-5.1 Students will be able to write an analytical essay of 5–6 paragraphs in which they develop a clear arguable thesis, supp... W-5.2 Students will be able to write a comparative essay of 5–6 paragraphs that examines two texts, ideas, or perspectives, us... W-5.3 Students will be able to plan and write an extended research report of 5–7 paragraphs, evaluating the credibility of at ... W-5.4 Students will be able to identify and articulate features of their own writing voice and deliberately apply stylistic ch...
6th Grade	W-6.1 Students will be able to write an extended analytical essay of 6–8 paragraphs that develops a nuanced, arguable thesis, ... W-6.2 Students will be able to write effectively across at least three genres, demonstrating understanding of the conventions,... W-6.3 Students will be able to independently plan, research, draft, revise, and publish an extended research project of 7–9 pa...

Grade	Writing Objectives
	W-6.4 Students will be able to compile a curated writing portfolio that includes at least four pieces from across the year rep...
7th Grade	W-7.1 Students will be able to write a sophisticated literary essay of 7–9 paragraphs that develops and sustains a complex, ar... W-7.2 Students will be able to independently select an appropriate genre for a given communicative purpose and audience, produ... W-7.3 Students will be able to independently produce a scholarly research essay of 8–10 paragraphs that develops an original r... W-7.4 Students will be able to write a developed reflective essay on their identity and growth as a writer, analyzing specific... W-7.5 Students will be able to write an extended piece of creative writing that demonstrates deliberate use of literary techni... W-7.6 Students will be able to produce a well-organized, coherent written response under timed exam conditions, applying strat...
8th Grade	W-8.1 Students will be able to write a fully developed critical essay of 8–10 paragraphs that applies a named critical framewo... W-8.2 Students will be able to produce a polished piece of writing intended for an authentic public audience (e.g., an op-ed, ... W-8.3 Students will be able to independently produce an extended research paper of 10–12 paragraphs that develops an original,... W-8.4 Students will be able to curate a metacognitive writing development portfolio that includes representative pieces across... W-8.5 Students will be able to write an extended creative piece that engages meaningfully with a social, political, or cultura... W-8.6 Students will be able to produce high-quality written responses across a range of exam task types (e.g., analytical essa...
9th Grade	W-9.1 Students will be able to independently produce a capstone critical essay of 10–12 paragraphs representing their highest ... W-9.2 Students will be able to compile and publish an authentic public writing portfolio — comprising at least three polished ... W-9.3 Students will be able to independently design, research, draft, revise, and publish a capstone research project of 12–15... W-9.4 Students will be able to produce a 3rd cycle capstone writing retrospective — a substantial reflective document curating... W-9.5 Students will be able to conceive, develop, and complete an independent creative writing project of significant scope — ... W-9.6 Students will be able to produce exam-quality writing at the level required for the diversified cycle and internationall...
10th Grade	W-10.1 Students will be able to produce analytical and argumentative essays at the level expected for university entry — demons... W-10.2 Students will be able to develop a professional writing identity — including a curated public portfolio, a personal stat... W-10.3 Students will be able to independently produce a scholarly research paper of 15–18 paragraphs developing a significant o... W-10.4 Students will be able to produce a detailed diversified cycle writing development plan — evaluating their current writin... W-10.5 Students will be able to develop and sustain an intentional creative writing practice across the year — producing a body... W-10.6 Students will be able to produce exam-quality writing at the level required for internationally benchmarked assessments ...
11th Grade	W-11.1 Students will be able to produce fully realized independent scholarly writing at the level expected for university first... W-11.2 Students will be able to establish a fully realized and publicly visible writing presence — through a curated public por... W-11.3 Students will be able to independently produce a fully realized capstone research publication representing the highest l...

Grade	Writing Objectives
	W-11.4 Students will be able to produce a comprehensive writing legacy statement and post-secondary writing vision — reflecting... W-11.5 Students will be able to complete, polish, and present a fully realized creative writing legacy project — a substantial,... W-11.6 Students will be able to perform at their personal peak level in internationally benchmarked writing examinations — demo...

Graduation Profile

What a Colegio Bilingüe Ciudad Blanca Graduate Looks Like

A student who completes this curriculum will graduate as a confident, critically literate, and ethically engaged bilingual communicator who can:

Listen with critical precision, empathy, and civic responsibility across academic, professional, and community contexts.

Speak with authority, nuance, and intellectual courage — in academic seminars, professional settings, public forums, and creative performances.

Read with sophisticated critical awareness, theoretical fluency, and a deep commitment to diverse and inclusive literary culture.

Write with an authoritative scholarly voice, professional versatility, creative distinctiveness, and a lifelong commitment to writing as a practice of thinking, advocacy, and self-expression.